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Virginia Board of Education, Special Meeting, Wednesday, August 28, 2024

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Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	6h 36m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CPWc0CBz680
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:04:04] a.m. and I'll now call this meeting to order as is customary for this board we will begin our meeting with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of

[00:04:12] Allegiance. Is there a motion to approve the agenda as presented? So moved. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Dr. Bryce? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Chair votes aye. Okay the staff has provided members of the board with the draft minutes

[00:05:15] before this meeting is there a motion to approve the minutes as presented second mr. Hanson miss Kilgore miss McPherson dr. Bryce hi mr. Rotherham miss Ashton miss Holton and chair votes okay good morning everyone we've gotten the clerical business out of out of the way here this morning and we have a wonderful student performance before us it's the pleasure of the board to have with us

[00:05:51] today students from henrico high school center for the arts we appreciate you all being the feature of our wonderful arts performers this this morning for us to ground us as we begin our work and i will now ask dr bryce to provide us with a brief introduction of these talented students we are delighted to present to you today the exceptional young choral singers from the henrico county public schools including the henrico high school and the center for the arts specialty center leading these talented students is mr morgan day now on his 18th year as the choral director at

[00:06:28] henrico high school in addition to his work with the choir mr day also teaches musical theater and class piano at the center for the arts his dedication and impact on music education were recognized when he was named henrico county's music educator of the year for 2020 to 2021.

[00:06:43] this performance will feature two inspiring selections a choice to change the world composed by philip kevin johnson this piece challenges us all to consider our role in making the world a better place i dream a world a poignant musical setting of langston hughes profound poem masterfully composed by andre thomas henrico high school's principal mrs karen castillo rose and the director of the center for the arts dr stephanie poxson are immensely proud of the dedication and artistry demonstrated by these students and their instructors their hard work and focus have have brought this meaningful music to life for this special occasion. Please

[00:07:21] join me in welcoming the outstanding singers from Henrico High School and the

[00:07:25] Center for the Arts. I move that the Virginia Board of Education convene in a

[00:15:24] closed meeting for the following purposes: discussion or consideration by the Board of Education of information relating to the denial, suspension, or revocation of teacher licenses subject to the exclusion and subdivision 11 of Section 2.2-3705.2, pursuant to Section 2.2-3711-A40 of the Code of Virginia, and consultation with counsel regarding specific legal matters requiring the provision of legal advice pursuant

[00:15:58] to Virginia Code Section 2.2-3711-A8 of the Virginia Code, and legal counsel to the Virginia Board of Education and staff whose presence will aid in the board's consideration this matter participate in the closed meeting they're a second

[00:16:16] okay and now we will go into closed session thank you we convene today in a

[01:26:12] closed meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the motion above and in accordance with the Freedom of Information Act section 2.2-3712 of the Code of Virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each members knowledge only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote indicating the substance of the departure that in his or her judgment has taken place the statement of the

[01:26:51] departure will be recorded in the minutes. Is there a second? Okay, a motion has been made by Mr. Hansen and seconded by Ms. McPherson. Mr. Hansen? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr.

[01:27:12] Bryce? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. And chair votes aye. Okay, in case number 2024-020, the chair will entertain a motion to issue a teaching license to the applicant.

[01:27:33] So moved. Second. A motion has been made by Ms. Ashton and seconded by Mr. Hanson. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Bryce? Aye. Mr. Rotherham?

[01:27:48] Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. And chair votes aye. Okay, in case 2024-011, the chair will entertain a motion to deny a teaching license to Heather Michelle Vanden-Arend.

[01:28:05] So moved. Second. Motion made by Ms. Holton, seconded by Dr. Bryce. Mr. Hansen. Aye. Ms. Kilgore. Aye. Ms. Ashton. Aye. Dr. Bryce.

[01:28:21] Aye. Mr. Rotherham. Aye. Ms. McPherson. Aye. Ms. Holton. Aye. And chair votes aye. Motion carries. okay so we are moving into the public comment section of our meeting this morning and as stated in the board's bylaws it's the pleasure of the board to accept public comment on all matters related to public education in virginia before we begin our public comment today i would like to share a few comments about the manner in which public comment will be conducted i ask that you model professionalism dignity and respect for others as you share your thoughts today

[01:28:56] as adults it's important that we model civil respectful public discourse for our students and our children who are either here in attendance with us or maybe participating by virtual means when you begin please provide your name your role or affiliation and where you live in virginia all remarks will be directed to the chair and not to any other individual speakers will have three minutes to share their remarks that three minutes is on the screen that you see that will be before you as you stand at the mic there you'll notice that the timer screens will begin with three at green one minute the screen will turn yellow and then the

[01:29:34] screen will turn red when your time is up at that point we ask that you close your comments prop promptly all speakers should provide their comments to mr. Joe crook Joe can you raise your hand please thank you and the public comments that have been written will be provided to the board as soon as possible I would like to make one other reminder please that if you are sending written comments to the board and the board you want the board to get them promptly we need to have them emailed to boe

[01:30:10] at doe virginia.gov instead of individually emailing them to people it just makes it so much easier if we have the right place for those things to go so that we can get them out quickly to all board members so that being said um i would like to ask rania latif to please come forward first

[01:30:38] followed by scott braebrand good morning chair creasy respected board members and superintendent koons my name is rania latif and i'm the president of a student-led organization called matchup my leadership team and i are so happy to be here this morning i have with me zabe zaheer charlie Roderick, Quinn Ray, Erin Kim, and Selma Sherdell. We want to thank you guys for listening to us over the past few months and for honoring our request for Unified PE to be an improved course that can

[01:31:18] satisfy the health and PE graduation requirement for any Virginia students. This is huge. By making this change, we have immediately and drastically increased the scope of Unified PE, which enhances inclusivity in our schools and furthers for the health and well-being of students with disabilities.

[01:31:36] It also provides students like me the opportunity to interact with and nurture our peers who need it the most. I especially want to thank Dr. Coons and her staff, including Dr. Wallace, who have patiently guided us through the programs and standards of learning and educated us on how such change must go through the right channels to be successful.

[01:31:56] Thank you, Secretary Holton, for responding to us and keeping our spirits up. Thank you to our awesome PE teacher, Mrs. Misencheck, and assistant principal, Dr. Parrish, for educating us and encouraging us to lobby for this worthwhile cause. And last but not least, we are grateful to Dr. McDade, our own superintendent, who actually attends our Unified Sports tournaments and has been a huge source of encouragement.

[01:32:21] And to you, the Virginia Board of Education, our heartfelt gratitude. I'd like to leave you with a final thought and one invitation. Unified Sports is a very special community. my teammates hug more than

they score points they don't claim any championships but their words always win me over they inspire us to have our game on ready to uplift and cheer others both on and off the court so thank you guys for listening to us got Braybrand followed by Mary Ann Burke

[01:32:55] good morning President Creasy Dr. Coons and members of the Board of Education my name is Scott Braybrand I'm executive director for VAS as you take your final vote today to approve this performance and support framework we offer the following final feedback. We appreciate Dr. Coons and this board's ongoing commitment to collaboration with VAS. We appreciate your belief in transparency and high expectations, the decoupling of accreditation from accountability, the focus on durable skills embedded in the high school readiness 3E network. The 3E network

[01:33:34] still needs some additional flexibility to help some of our smaller school divisions. We also deeply appreciate the delay in incorporating the performance tasks at the elementary and middle school level and we'd like to continue to partner with you on those tasks. We appreciate you limiting advanced coursework to math from middle school readiness and for including the applied studies diploma in the six-year extended graduation rate while retaining GCI under high school readiness. We are concerned with the addition of advanced social studies and science coursework to middle school just one year from now as there are currently major inequities across the commonwealth in student access to that coursework as well as

[01:34:12] middle school teacher licensure issues. We understand virtual options are being explored, however, it's too early to agree to this incorporation until more defined supports are in place. As we've shared before, we remain concerned about the on-track, off-track summit of categories.

[01:34:28] Even with your updated partial modeling using 23-24 school year data, which is in their presentation today, we still see the new framework suggests over 55% of our schools are off-track or need intensive support we strongly believe at vast all of our schools can continue to improve we don't believe the majority of our schools are in those two categories as we said last month ask yourself if this new framework aligns with the state that just received a number one ranking for business from cnbc that included within its methodology a number one ranking for education continue to do data modeling around this framework we need to see the specific data

[01:35:06] breakdowns by category. We also remain concerned about the EL semester guidance going from 11 to 3 and with the ESSA state plan making the minimum end number now go from 30 to 15 students. This will identify more schools in need of support without more state resources to support those schools. Finally, we understand you want to look at standard setting and new cut scores for this year's assessments on the new reading and math standards. We deeply agree and believe with your consultant that, quote, the credibility of cut scores is closely related to the process.

[01:35:40] How is this ID matching process that will be discussed today, this approach, how is it the same or different from our current standard setting process? Transparency and clarity will be key as you look at this issue. As always, VAS looks forward to continuing to partner with you on this important work. Thank you very much. Okay, Mary Ann Burke followed by Vanessa Hall.

[01:36:04] Good morning, Chair Greasy and the rest of the board. My name is Marianne Burke. I come from Fairfax, and I'm with For Public Education. I'm concerned.

[01:36:21] I'm concerned that this DOE does not have the analytical skills needed to appropriately analyze the data for the proposed accreditation plan, and that they are willing to misuse data in order to disparage our public schools.

[01:36:38] Here's the evidence that leads me to these concerns. Last week, the DOE claimed Fairfax County was underperforming on SOL tests. However, the data were inappropriately analyzed, only including some of the scores. When objections were made, the DOE spokesperson said that all the scores would be reported in the fall.

[01:37:01] Meanwhile, Virginians are left with Youngkin's misinformation about Fairfax underperforming. Board members, please know that the press release and conclusions made last week should be corrected in the media. In 2023, the DOE singled out Fairfax County schools as failing because SAT scores had declined.

[01:37:23] The truth was that Fairfax County SAT scores were above both the state and global SAT averages, and SAT scores dropped across Virginia and other states and around the globe. Also, Youngkins, DOE, used misinformation in their claim that there was an honesty gap in Virginia because SOL and NAP scores differed.

[01:37:49] Published information had warned that these two tests measure very different things and scores cannot be directly compared. Even now, the governor refers to the honesty gap, showing that the administration still doesn't understand or does not want to give up this talking point that disparages public schools.

[01:38:11] And who can forget that more than a year into his administration, Governor Youngkin blamed Virginia's stagnant SOL scores on the previous administration, claiming that he was set up by them by them lowering expectations.

[01:38:27] Instead, it showed that this DOE does not understand how SOL cutoff scores are determined, And this is a critical skill for those analyzing test scores. Now we're being asked to trust that this accreditation system will accurately reflect the status of each school.

[01:38:47] The potentially serious impacts on students in school systems gives me grave concern about this plan. Thank you. Vanessa Hall, followed by Justin Hagley. Hi. Good morning, Chair Creasy and board.

[01:39:10] I want to thank you for the opportunity to speak. I'm very sorry that I'll be expressing disappointment. I'm someone who really likes to be collaborative. My name is Vanessa Hall. I'm a parent whose student will be directly affected by these punitive policies. And I'm asking for accountability from you to Virginia families and our schools.

[01:39:29] After reading the materials, it's clear that VDOE ignored listening session feedback. We asked for transparency, yet where are the policy red lines, much less comparisons of the old versus new standards? We asked for thoughtful measures, yet these judge our children based on college coursework rather than grade level proficiency.

[01:39:48] Do you know how many students cannot access advanced classes due to language, disability, cost, or availability? We asked for equitable support for student success. Instead, these measures punish schools with too many low-income English language learning or disabled students.

[01:40:05] We asked for support for English language learners, but these measures throw them under the bus, and frankly, I'd love to see any of you learn a new language in three semesters sufficient to take science and history tests in that language.

[01:40:21] We asked for funding, yet you offer an unfunded mandate. Where are you going to get the money to flesh out this policy, implement it, and then support schools that can't meet these draconian measures? We asked for evidence-based plans. Where's the data to support that such a disruptive overhaul improves education outcomes?

[01:40:40] We asked for improvements. Instead, these plans will harm our public schools, student opportunity, and teacher retention, as nearly half of our schools are pushed out of good standing, seemingly overnight. PowerPoints are not policy. Policy is in the details. The details that are missing here is what will happen to the hundreds of schools that cannot meet these arbitrary standards.

[01:41:01] Yet, you've fast-tracked approval of these bare-bones, devastating policies that will harm our students, families, schools, and Virginia's reputation as an education powerhouse. Our governor has spent the last three years amplifying a false message that Virginia schools are failing, and now he has you to ensure that that is true with these absurd policies and punishments.

[01:41:24] Our students must be treated as individuals, not test scores, so that they can receive support in schools to enable their success in school and life. Thus, we need fully funded schools. The recent JLARC studies highlighted that teachers are leaving our schools due to poor funding and lack of respect, like teacher snitch lines.

[01:41:43] A heavy workload from excessive high-stakes testing and these accountability standards doesn't help retain teachers either. Please do not waste money on additional accountability measures when we need money to educate and support our students, particularly in lower-income communities.

[01:42:00] Please fully fund our schools, get class sizes down, and listen to parents, not operatives about what our schools need. Thank you very much. Justin Hagley, followed by Amy Wheeler. Are either of them in the room?

[01:42:23] Val Renford? Rainford? I'm Val Renford. I'm the Vice President of Local Program Services with Special Olympics Virginia.

[01:42:40] I live in Chesterfield County. Last year Special Olympics Virginia partnered with 555 schools in Virginia to promote inclusion through our Unified Champion Schools program, or UCS. UCS brings together students with and without intellectual disabilities through our Unified Sports program, inclusive student leadership opportunities, and whole school engagement and educational activities.

[01:43:05] The goal is to build more inclusive school environments where all students feel accepted. The University of Massachusetts does a survey every year with our school liaisons across the nation. And those statistics demonstrate the importance and the effectiveness of this program.

[01:43:20] And I'll leave those statistics with you today. Unified PE is a component of Unified Sports, a program that brings approximately equal numbers of students with and without intellectual disabilities together to participate on sports teams. Currently, Unified PE is an elective class that provides inclusive sports, fitness, and leadership opportunities for students.

[01:43:42] Some schools use Unified PE as their practice time for unified sports, which enables students to participate who may not have transportation to stay after school, and it also gives students the opportunity to participate in other extracurricular activities after school.

[01:43:59] This structure works for many schools, and we try to be as flexible as we can to allow schools to do what works for them. Unified PE is growing in Virginia with over 56 schools participating last year. Unified PE provides an environment for students with I.D. to participate in sports training and competition with their general education peers as equals.

[01:44:21] It provides opportunity for health and fitness through our Unified Fitness Challenge, our nutrition lessons, and our Strong Minds resources. It provides leadership opportunities for our students with and without I.D. And it builds lasting friendships for students who may never have the opportunity to be in class together if it was not for Unified PE.

[01:44:42] My understanding is the proposal that you're being considered today is it gives school systems the option of whether to offer unified PE to meet the criteria for 9th grade and 10th grade PE. And that fits with how we operate. We try to give schools the options to formulate their Unified Champion Schools program in a way that fits their needs.

[01:45:02] While I haven't talked to many unified PE teachers to know their opinions about this proposal, I do know that unified PE is impactful for all students and that it provides an opportunity to offer P.E. in a unique way that involves students of all abilities as equals. Special Loans Virginia is grateful for the Virginia Department of Education support of this program since its inception and 16 years ago actually now. And we look forward to working with even more schools in the years to come to build socially inclusive schools in which all students

[01:45:35] excel. Thank you. Okay. Ging Sivigny followed by John Carter Moline. Good morning. My name is Ginge Savini. I live in Burke. My daughters and grandsons went to school in Fairfax County where my daughter is now a very dedicated high school special education teacher. I think we all

[01:46:10] share a deep appreciation of the value of education and its crucial role in the lives of individuals and also communities. The impact of your decisions on Virginia's children, families, schools, communities, and the quality of life in Virginia has far-reaching implications.

[01:46:33] The history of public education in Virginia is filled with both heroes and villains. When people look back on these times, will the actions this board takes be looked upon with gratitude or shame? Will you be respected champions of public education, supporters of the common wheel?

[01:46:54] Or will you be looked on with dismay the way we now revile those who dismantled our public schools in the 50s and 60s? It's your choice. John Carter Moline.

[01:47:16] Good morning. My name is Carter Moline. I live in Norfolk, Virginia, and I have raised a daughter there. She is the first person in my family and my wife's family to not graduate high school in the last 100 years or so.

[01:47:39] The reason for this is the word autism. That one single word does not convey ability or intelligence. And yet, it does exclude her from the constitutional protections that other children have. Let me explain.

[01:47:55] Since age 12, my daughter has lived a life of segregation and apartheid. She hasn't had the Pledge of Allegiance in school. She hasn't set foot in a school bus. She has no school photos or yearbooks. no sports teams no choir no orchestra no friends no standards of learning no diploma you see autism is a term that defines a diversity for some children like my daughter it mandates exclusion and inequity this cannot be fixed by private school because private schools do not have to

[01:48:32] take and retain children with autism this cannot be fixed with charter schools because charter schools do not have to take and retain children with autism this cannot be fixed with public school because public school does not have to take and retain children with autism when my daughter was first identified with the word autism people told me that i could get her help because of that word as if she had gained rights well that's a lie when a medical doctor or a psychologist labels a child with autism. They are not empowering that child with rights. They are

[01:49:10] burdening them with wrongs. They are identifying the child as less than equal and pushing them into laws that were not constructed on the Equal Protection Clause of the United States Constitution. My opinion as a father who has navigated this system is that there were events that happened to my daughter that were criminal, events that were unconstitutional, and events that violated international human rights law. None of this was ever considered because it was outside the paradigm of special education law. That is my point. I am informing you, the Board of Education,

[01:49:50] that up to this date, August 28, 2024, that autism is litigated incorrectly and has always been litigated incorrectly. Until that changes, there's nothing I can do about it. So just today, I sent a letter to the United States Attorney General and I sent a letter to the Virginia Attorney General. This is craziness. Why does a father have to do that? I mean, these people are talking about standards of learning. What the hell's that? My daughter hasn't had a standards of learning test for years, and she's a resident of Virginia. What the heck? So thank you for your

[01:50:28] time. And Olivia is signed up. I guess it's not here. Is Olivia Moline here? Michael Karabinos? I'm Michael Karabinos, parent in Chesterfield.

[01:50:48] Early on in my career, I was delivering a new PC to a co-worker who pulled a paperclip out of the power supply because he wanted a new PC. The lesson, the unethical life hack there being, if it ain't broke and you want it replaced, break it on purpose. Since this governor has stumbled into office on the back of a misused quote by a has-been phoning an opponent, He and his allies on this board have acted like they have a mandate to dismantle successful schools in order to sell voucher systems and charters to enrich his friends in private education.

[01:51:27] Snitch lines, watered down history standards, abusive, abusive model policies, underfunding, the empaneling of people from states with far worse records of education than this state on higher level boards.

[01:51:49] accountability crisis that's about to be manufactured by this new policy. These new consultant written standards are crafted to provide a manufactured metric foundation to the false claim that this administration keeps making. But our schools are not failing. Virginia has some of the best schools in the country in spite of his efforts over the last three years. The public schools that are successful don't scare parents, don't inspire parents to pull their kids out,

[01:52:27] Don't inspire parents to put their kids in private school so it doesn't sell policies that sell vouchers and charters that put that money, the billions of dollars of education that we provide in the pockets of private citizens who have these companies.

[01:52:46] This is just one more case of taking public money and finding a way to move it into the private pocket. And these accountability standards are designed to fail by consultants who were asked to cook the books to make them fail. How else besides a cooked book, where are you going to see a 55% unsuccessful rate on a school system that is as successful as Virginia? So look in the mirror before you make your vote. Ladies and gentlemen, we don't do the clapping and all of that in this

[01:53:24] room. Thank you. If there are any other speakers, you can line up behind the microphone, please. Hi, my name is Todd Truitt, and I'm the parent of two public school students from Arlington, Virginia. I would like to speak this morning strongly in support of the proposed accountability framework. As a New York Times editorial board member recently wrote, the least privileged kids have been paying the price in the numerous states left and right that have failed to live up to their

[01:54:04] accountability system responsibility under the 2015 Every Student Succeeds Act. Moreover, a few months ago, Obama's Secretary of Education, Arne Duncan, tweeted in support of Virginia updating its accountability, stating how our soon-to-be former accountability is, quote, lying to parents, end quote. With this new accountability framework, Virginia will finally live up to its responsibility to Virginia students, parents, and communities a proper disclosure of academic performance data. Reading in the press the very few criticisms of this much-needed revamp, they overwhelmingly concern the feelings of the adults running school systems

[01:54:44] performing below average not families whose children attend those schools to whom secretary duncan was referring like the criticism about the label off track how many parents goal is for their child to attend a school in the bottom 50th percentile clearly those schools need to make changes or the criticism 54 of schools would be in the bottom two categories in maryland only 24 of schools ranked in the bottom two out of five categories and the administration of governor Wes Moore bluntly said its system was not being honest and wasn't holding anyone accountable.

[01:55:18] In almost every one of these handful of criticisms, there seems to be an underlying fatalism that those schools are just never going to improve, so let's not discuss it publicly. It reminds me of Mitt Romney's 2012 campaign, where he said that discussions around income inequality should not be among the broader public, but should instead be held in quiet rooms. Here in Virginia, we're going to stop talking about educational inequality in quiet rooms and start talking about it among the broader public. Lastly, I strongly endorse the middle school accelerated coursework readiness factor and the latest changes to give Virginia school districts extra credit for those kids

[01:55:55] successfully taking algebra before eighth grade. That change is the same as what Florida has, which is working well there. Last year, around 60% of Virginia school districts had some seventh graders taking the algebra and, of course, SOL. If a school district not offering seventh grade algebra has an issue with algebra or geometry teachers, there's virtual Virginia. And if a school district won't provide this critical opportunity, the public needs to be properly informed, not a conversation held behind closed doors. As Barack Obama said when signing ESSA, quote, there's nothing more essential to living up to the ideals of this nation than making sure

[01:56:34] every child is able to achieve their God-given potential. Thank you very much. Hello, my name is Cheryl Binkley. I am here on behalf of For Public Education.

[01:56:54] These accountability measures remind me of my grandparents' day when the saying to children was, stop crying or I'll give you something to cry about. The people that you are going to hold accountable with these are not the policymakers. It's not the people that are claimed to be talking in quiet rooms. It's children, brown children, immigrant children, black children, poor children

[01:57:27] who do not have the luxury of living in the most affluent communities of the state. Yet they are the people that you are going to hold accountable by calling them and their schools failing. over half of the children in Virginia. That's how you're going to label them. These are not for the children or for our schools or even for the private schools who will charge additional tuition granted or the voucher systems that get them to Disney World once a year.

[01:58:04] This is a disaster. It is made to create chaos and made to create punishment. Please don't do this. This is not what Virginia does. We support our kids.

[01:58:21] There's no money in this for the schools. Very little money, $49,000 a year per district. That's not going to help them get better. Yet we're going to continue to hold the line on funding our schools for the things that they need.

[01:58:38] This is enough. Please don't continue and follow through on this boondoggle. It's just horrifying to someone who's taught special ed students, students of color, and students who needed, who were, I've taught at Title I schools.

[01:58:58] Those are our children. Those are the people we love. Those are the families that are working two and three jobs to get their kids through a really highly regarded American school system. But they won't be able to because of these policies, because it's going to increase the worst of the conditions that they're suffering from.

[01:59:23] Please don't do this.

[01:59:40] Thank you for the opportunity to speak with you today. My name is Amy Beaumont, and I'm a parent in Arlington County. I speak today in strong support of the proposed SSA State Plan and its revised school performance and support framework. We have an urgent need for a new accountability framework because the current system is failing to provide an honest accounting of school performance to parents and the community.

[02:00:03] By placing too much emphasis on growth and not enough on mastery, the current system failed to reflect massive post-COVID learning losses. That is concerning because if you can't see a problem, how can you fix it? To better see the scope of the current accountability system's shortcomings, it's helpful to look at real examples.

[02:00:24] Let's look at Carlin Springs Elementary in Arlington. It has exceptional teachers, students, and community, but as a Title I school, it was vulnerable to the disruptions from COVID. How has it done over the last few years? If you look at the current accountability system rating, all appears well.

[02:00:44] Its school quality indicators are all green, and its math achievement combined rate is 88%, well above the 70% threshold. But is this an accurate picture? Sadly, it is not. If you dig deeper, you will see that only 39% of students pass their math SOL, a sobering and concerning statistic.

[02:01:05] How do you go from 39% of students passing their math SOL to 88% math achievement combined rate, as reported by the current accountability system? That occurs by overweighting growth and excluding recently arrived English learners.

[02:01:22] Clearly, it's important to recognize growth and give credit to the fantastic teachers that foster it. But ultimately, we need to get students across the finish line and achieve content mastery. By placing greater emphasis on mastery, the new framework will do that.

[02:01:41] It will provide a truer picture of school performance, which will make it easier to target support to schools most in need, and will allow schools and communities to make more informed decisions about what is needed to develop students to their fullest potential. actions will produce real gains and achievement not illusory gains which only exist on paper thank you for the thought and the time that went into the school performance and support framework and your extensive outreach to schools parents and communities throughout the development process the quality of the final product is impressive and will benefit virginia students greatly thank you

[02:02:18] are there others that wish to speak during public comment before i close the public comment session okay at this time the board will take a break uh before we begin the rest of oh i'm sorry someone else i didn't know if you were getting up for some other reason please come forward so my name is carol mother i serve on the school board in spotsylvania and i serve as a math coach

[02:02:55] in northern virginia school system and frankly i'm exhausted and i had not planned to speak to you today i had planned to just come and listen um but the moving targets and the absolute misinformation campaign and making it impossible for school divisions to know how they're being measured what they're being measured on when they're being measured on it with little to no instructional resources little to no it's time i have dove delved into um this again which is why I came today to hear what you were going to say, and I'm looking forward to it, and I'm

[02:03:35] looking forward to collaborating on fixing this, but I've been doing this for 28 years now, I think, and if we succeed as a teacher in a classroom teaching math, mostly middle school, I've done the highest achieving students, I've taught special ed, I've taught kids who are taking algebra, I've taught kids who are taking geometry in eighth grade, and I've taught kids who have never passed enough so well and frankly as soon as we get to a place where we understand what's being measured and we've aligned our instruction to teach it and we've built in

[02:04:11] scaffold for students who struggle oh well you know we must be doing something wrong so we have to change it it's dishonest and i'm so sick of that message and i'm so exhausted for having to go and stand in front of a room full of teachers and explain no sorry you got really good at doing your work that they told you and the information they wanted you to teach, so let's change it all.

[02:04:33] And that's all this is. You have now instituted new language standards, new math standards with no crosswalk year to even go from the old standards to the new standards, and you want to put new cut scores, and you want to do a new accreditation system, and you want to change the testing platform all at the same time so that you can say 55% or is the estimate or 60% depending on what you read of our schools are failing.

[02:04:57] And it's just not true. That is the dishonesty. Our school buildings in Virginia are doing amazing things for kids every single day. Kids who struggle, kids who are new language learners, kids who are

excelling. And we are working to make progress in every single one of those areas.

[02:05:15] And the single one thing that I will have to say about this is I went to those listening sessions and at every listening session I went to it was talked about growth. We can only start with what the kids come with and measure growth. I'm all for measuring mastery, but you have to start at where the kids are.

[02:05:31] Not taking into account growth measures in your accreditation system is absolutely wrong, and it takes us back 20 years, and it's just not the way we should be moving. I was so proud of the fact that we put growth measures into our accountability system with the last administration, and that should continue.

[02:05:51] Anybody else like to speak today? Public comment? Okay, come on. If anybody else is prepared and wishes to speak today, please come and stand behind the mic.

[02:06:12] Otherwise, we'll close the public comment session after this speaker. - Hi, I'm Jeff Koop, I'm from Richmond, Virginia. Like the previous speaker, I wasn't prepared to come and I wasn't planning to speak today. I've voiced my concerns about the accountability and accreditation system before I participated in listening sessions and I provided comments.

[02:06:37] So, here we are, I do have reservations, I do support growth, my kids attended failing school during the No Child Left Behind era in the 1990s, early 2000s, and they came away with great educations and they went on to college and they succeeded, and the kids, Many of whom were disadvantaged, kids of color, English language learners, they also succeeded.

[02:07:11] And this was the failing schools that my kids went to. And so I'm a supporter of growth. I agree with the last speaker that we do have to keep our eye on mastery, but I think in the educational research, basically what separates those mastery for some from others is time.

[02:07:38] Kids need more time, which calls into question grade level standards. And so if this system is going to work, there are a few things that I'd like to suggest that are more procedural and about process.

[02:07:57] We need to favor internal responsibility of teachers and community over heavy external accountability. There should be quality support, and this quality support should be asset-based, not deficit-based. So, if you're going to go through with this system, let's keep the focus on assets and not be thinking about deficits.

[02:08:21] We need to be looking at drivers and factors that are causing underperformance in particular schools, and those factors will be varied. We need educators and community to look at theories of change.

[02:08:43] The system is going to need to put a lot of emphasis on formative assessment and quality of feedback. learning. And if this is an unfunded mandate, the support, the coaching, the external support needs to be there for schools who really are in need to improve. And they need time. I think that there are often, there are expectations that change will occur quickly and it's going

[02:09:18] to take effort on everyone's part over time to make it work that's it for me thank you thank you and we will close public comment now thank you board will

[02:09:31] take a break for 10 minutes we are back in session and the first thing that we

[02:26:56] need to do is is there a motion to waive first review and approve the items on the consent agenda so move second okay okay hearing none mr. Hansen miss Kilgore hi miss McPherson dr. Bryce hi

mr. Rotherham hi miss Ashton miss Holton and chair votes aye okay Katie Carroll we are up for you I guess is it's

[02:27:35] not I'm sorry I'm sorry however let's see you want to go ahead perfect good morning i'm m cooper deputy superintendent of teaching and learning as first presented to the board in april videoe has created a school support framework focused on four buckets of support academic which focuses on effective instruction staffing which focuses on strengthening the talent pipeline organizational learning which provides capacity building for teachers and leaders and

[02:28:14] climate supports that help remove barriers for students so schools have a positive healthy learning environment each of these supports is grounded in evidence and research of high leverage strategies for improving schools and is supported by vdoe experts across all teams in the agency this best in class model supports schools when they need it and where they need it today my colleague brendan albin and i will share with you what these supports look like for three tiers of schools tier one tier two and tier three on slide three you'll see virginia's tiered support

[02:28:54] system that provides school strategies for improving schools based on their school performance levels this system provides general support to all schools in virginia which is in tier one more specific support for schools labeled targeted support intervention and then deeper more intense supports for schools that are identified as needing comprehensive support or those divisions with MOUs. As schools need more support, they move through the tiers to receive additional capacity building opportunities and funding. And I'll share some examples of each bucket

[02:29:28] of support by tier and how our Office of School Quality operates to support this work. On the next slide, all schools in Virginia have access to tier one support. So an example of academic supports for all schools was our spring literacy implementation network that provided a series of four trainings for division and school leaders in creating their division literacy plan required by the virginia literacy act during these trainings leaders learned about strong division literacy plans the implementation of our vla playbook high quality instructional

[02:30:07] materials and the key actions that educators should take to ensure success of implementing that division literacy plan. On the next slide you'll see an excellent example from Galex Elementary School and Galex City Schools. They took advantage of the tier one support of our literacy implementation network by sending their principals and reading specialists alongside division leaders to all of the trainings. They used the VLA playbook shared at the network to create their own school literacy plan aligned to their division's literacy plan and division's

[02:30:46] literacy goals and strategies. They felt the trainings were very affirming in the work they had been leaning into and were able to polish some of the strategies and plans they had for the upcoming year. They planned evidence-based reading instruction, made clear connections with professional learning and their high quality curriculum, aligned their tutoring with Lexia, and quality parent engagement supports. Susan Hoke, GALAX's dedicated reading specialist, reflected on their progress noting that it feels like all the puzzle pieces are coming together,

[02:31:20] and this sentiment is echoed throughout their division. As GALAX has made significant strides in ensuring that their English learners and students with disability teams are well versed in the science of reading, they also have a literacy community at the school that is thriving, And through its dedicated

efforts and strategic practices, GALAX Elementary is paving the way for sustained literacy growth and success.

[02:31:45] Madam President, before we move on from GALAX, can I ask a question? Ms. Holden. Thank you. Can you tell me, would GALAX, based on current data, be rated as off-track or on-track or exceptional?

[02:32:08] or what do we know about how it would score? - Dr. Koons? - As we've discussed, that's anonymized data, so we don't have that information at this time. Thank you for asking. - Well, just looking at their-- - Ms. Hilton?

[02:32:26] - Thank you. Looking at their SOL scores, it looks to me like they're about average, and therefore that it's going to be probably an off-track school based on those numbers. Are there additional resources will be made available if it's off track miss holton if you remember in the last board meeting I requested a list of just generalized examples for all of these tiers so none of this that you see today is full and complete those tiered

[02:33:03] supports that would come with each one of these tiers would be specific to the needs of each individual school and/or division so I asked for at least just some ideas of examples this is not again full and complete okay all right on the next slide we'll talk about tier 2 supports so schools in tier 2 receive more supports and more opportunities for improving their schools so continuing with academic supports around literacy video we provided an opportunity for

[02:33:41] schools in tier 2 to attend the National Institute for Excellence in Teaching summer conference and then receive coaching during the upcoming school year to follow up on their implementation. NIT helps school leadership teams implement effective professional learning structures that center on the use of high-quality instructional materials. VDOE prioritized these grants grant funds for those schools with lower performing scores on the SOL assessment. So in the next slide you'll see some examples of schools from

[02:34:15] chesapeake public schools rena b right and truitt and they are examples of tsi schools that have a few critical areas of support that were needed each school received this grant and they sent a team of educators to support learning and bring best practices back to chesapeake city at the conference they learned how to create and execute teacher collaboration structures that focus on unpacking units and lessons within their high quality instructional materials addressing the diverse needs of students in their classrooms and then analyzing student work in

[02:34:51] order to make instructional decisions for the days and weeks ahead these feeder schools were glad that they were able to attend together because it strengthens the vertical alignment and maintains instructional consistency between the schools which further engages teachers in quality instructional practices which results in better outcomes for kids teachers will receive instructional coaching throughout the school year about their effective implementation of high quality materials and that will take place during their teacher collaboration time so when they're meeting with their peers or in content area groups and they'll offer personalized guidance feedback

[02:35:30] modeling of instructional practices to those educators this personalized approach allows teachers to refine their instructional practice and continue a cycle of improvement these supports will keep them on track for moving out of tier two in the near future now dr albin will share the work of the

office of school quality around our tier three schools if i may madam president miss holton before we move on from tier two can i uh i've got a couple more questions am i correct in understanding that the tier 2 schools correspond

[02:36:05] to the off-track schools on the new accountability system so off-track and tsi dr coons sure i appreciate your question we would provide tier 2 supports which will be more detailed in item d to our off-track or tier 2 schools that that's going to be explicitly discussed during the next presentation during item D so feel free to tell me if my next questions should wait until we get to item D thank you the supports that you have listed on the slide here the tier 2 support slide you've described the NIET which is

[02:36:44] sounds like terrific professional development spirit support I am looking for what is going to send supports to the schools that they, resources that they can use in their operations to implement evidence-based programs such as intensive tutoring, extended school year, merit pay, et cetera, et cetera.

[02:37:16] And I see on your slide you have extended school year grants and middle school math course. Those are both existing programs. Am I right? Yes. And those are grant-based programs that provide essentially seed money on a limited basis to a small number of schools across the Commonwealth. Is that right?

[02:37:39] Yes. The math teacher core is for recruitment and retention stipends, but yes, it's specifically for that critical need of math. for something like 30 schools extended school year grants at best um well you may do you know how many schools typically get qualified i think it's i think it's uh from what i've looked at it's a i think it's a seven or eight million dollar grant so 20 some schools perhaps not a seed money not paying the full cost of extended school year but helping schools essentially seed startup money

[02:38:13] for a small number of schools is there any proposal to extend those operational supports or other dollars going to divisions so that they will be available at the scale of schools expected to be targeted as off-track under the new system i.e 900 schools so i would just add all of the examples on this slide are really just one example in each area so there are several other supports in each category and other funding sources that support that. So on for the tier schools

[02:38:49] that's the 900 some schools that are going to be labeled off track what supports are we do we have that will be provided at scale that send dollars to local divisions to implement evidence-based practices such as extended school merit pay for teachers intensive tutoring other programs that take resources at the local level so miss Hilton new supports while in proposed while I understand your question once again I asked the team to

[02:39:25] come up with examples for these and so they're providing just a few examples the list is could be could include the things that you're talking about but again this is just some examples to give us a scale of what how deep level 1 how deep level 2 and how deep level 3 supports would be and I think thank you madam president I think my question goes exactly to that so I'm trying to understand exactly it is not a complete list is the point that's what I'm asking

[02:40:04] what are the what supports are going to be available at scale compared to the schools the 900 plus schools that are going to be labeled off track and I'm happy to wait if that question is better directed to dr. Coons or to the presenters under item D rather than to M I'm happy to you all tell me but somebody ought to be able to tell me that answer no and and I think I've also I'm gonna defer to dr. Coons in just one

second but I think I also just in the first tier discussion indicated that it would be specific to the needs of the school so if one school has a need that is very different than any other school

[02:40:43] in the state the department is gonna have to deal with that and that's a support that they will have to come up with to fix whatever the problem could be or assist in fixing that problem dr. Coons sure I'm happy to speak on slide three the team overviewed what tier was tier two was and on slide three they talked about it being a targeted support as we have had multiple presentations from our consultants targeted means there is a specific area of need such as math or literacy or extended year and the team is providing you examples of

[02:41:19] those supports as we know we had four hundred and eighteen million dollars by the General Assembly and the governor that was put towards high dosage tutoring and I just reviewed several plans this morning with school divisions adding and increasing dollars towards their tutoring for this year we also had 196 million dollars of additional funding for at-risk students 25 million dollars of additional funding for English language learners and an overall increase of 21.3 billion dollars so I think we have a lot of different funds that are being directed to your questions so if I may is the 418 million you're referring to that's the money that the General Assembly appropriated a

[02:41:58] year ago and told school divisions they could use it over one or two or three years but that it was time-limited and that the governor then molded into the directed into the all-in program is that the money you're referring to? Dr. Coons.

[02:42:14] The appropriation of four hundred and eighteen million dollars that the governor signed off on provides monies for high-intensity tutoring and the school divisions have submitted plans in which they are allocating those dollars for high-intensity tutoring. But am I right that it was one-time money to be spent over one to three years?

[02:42:34] And is there a proposal to replace those funds, to make those funds ongoing and sustainable and at the scale of the at-risk, the schools that are being identified off-trap? As the governor said last week at the press conference, we look to see where the data is driving to determine what the needs are.

[02:42:53] We can't assume that our schools are still going to be in a different place. there is funding for this year at this time miss mcpherson have expressed concern about this being a a new operation that is being thrust upon schools and the principals and as it relates to implementation so i'm pleased to hear that there's going to be funding because obviously anything of this size is going to need funding basically where the needs are so as i understand

[02:43:33] that after we do the first-year assessment, we'll have a better idea of exactly where those funds should be targeted. Has there also been any consideration given to using outside community resources, such as maybe our HBCUs for some of our underprivileged individuals, low-income communities, minority populations, things such as that that we could bring to bear as it relates to further development of support systems.

[02:44:07] - Dr. Keynes? - We absolutely partner with our community partners. I think one of the things that is important about the performance and support framework that we're going to talk about in the next presentation is how to transparently communicate to our community the needs so that people can come together and be able to provide those supports.

[02:44:25] I was on a phone call the days I'm running together, maybe last week, with Norfolk State University and with the Newport Shipyard about programming that they are working on specifically to work on apprenticeship grants for teachers so we are absolutely partnering with community resources but I think it's important again to make sure our communities know where our schools are so that we can bring all of the diverse resources oh yeah certainly the transparency is important in helping all of us understand exactly how we move forward in implementing a program of this life thank you Em or I'm sorry Dr.

[02:45:01] Albin that's you thank you so much members of the board so picking up on slide 8 under the revised accountability system the office of school quality will work indirectly with all schools and all tiers by connecting them to supports that are available either at state local or federal level that being said the heart of our work in the office of school quality is in is to intensively work with tier 3 schools which may include those who are federally identified as needing comprehensive supports or additional targeted supports or even some of those

[02:45:40] schools who under the accountability system are ranked as needing intensive support even if not federally identified the core of this work is by coaching school divisions through the process of performing a needs assessment and then developing a support plan which will implement data driven evidence-based interventions which may be supported by federal 1003a funds the osq the office of school quality team holds frequent meetings and provides coaching and shoulder-to-shoulder

[02:46:14] collaboration with these schools so as mentioned before tier 3 supports are provided to those schools who require comprehensive supports or additional targeted supports a major point to note is that the office of school quality has specialists and coordinators specifically allocated to school divisions with these schools to support the improvement planning as a coach and as a source of resources that are available to them in many situations schools who require tier 3 supports will

[02:46:49] have primary or piloted access to grant opportunities where the federal or state provided. So on slide 10, as an example of what this can look like, Hydenwood Elementary School in Newport News is a CSI federally identified school and have already received the following examples of supports from the Office of School Quality. An OSQ specialist has been assigned to the school division as a direct customer service contact and coach for this school. What happened

[02:47:22] at Hydenwood is typical of the following practices. Federal identifications are published by the Office of Accountability, which sparks where the Office of School Quality comes in to support these schools. Office of School Quality coordinators or specialists have scheduled one-on-one meetings with school leaders to work through the needs assessment, which helps them to pour through data, help identify problem statements, and then to set goals for improvement. This leads to the development of the school's support plan where interventions are selected tied to the Virginia

[02:48:02] support framework which you have seen today. This includes the selection of evidence-based interventions which will be selected and may be funded using federal 1003A funding. These specialists and coordinators assist as a coach through these steps. As you can see by the other bullets shown on the Hardenwood slide as federally as a federally identified school they also receive preferential opportunity to participate in state grants or other opportunities such as receiving the extended school year grant

[02:48:38] participation in the principal mentorship pilot all of which are managed by the office of school quality so I will now turn back to deputy madam president dr. Albin before we lose you can I ask you a

couple of questions thank you with respect to the office of school quality I think I heard you say that your most intensive efforts will be focused on the tier 3 schools right yes ma'am and that corresponds to the needs intensive

[02:49:12] support schools in the new state the new accountability system yes ma'am so that's 50 plus schools at least it may be more we can talk about that when we get to item D but what what is your current staffing oh oh and that you will be providing some support to the tier 2 schools as well tier 2 and tier 1 one of the major workloads we have in front of us is to develop a support toolkit whereby aligned to each of the domains in the Virginia support framework we seek

[02:49:48] to be able to put together a toolkit of all kinds of supports that would be available to all schools, whether they be Tier 1, Tier 2, or Tier 3, they would be sorted so different schools would have access to them. So our office will be able to take those supports which are available in different offices throughout the agency or other sources and to make it easily and findable for whether a school is Tier 3, Tier 2, or Tier 1.

[02:50:14] thank you as as as you know J Lark and others have assessed that your office the office of school quality here in Virginia comparing us to comparable states comparable offices in other states and otherwise is woefully understaffed for its current responsibilities has that changed at all how is your current staffing compared to the current need your to the capacity needed to serve the schools currently identified as in need of support and how

[02:50:49] will that change under the new system dr. Goons miss Holton as discussed last month in our board meeting I shared with you the report that was provided to the General Assembly around the office of school quality in addition we have five positions posted at this time thank you for your question that thank you for that answer that miss Holton that doesn't fully answer my question so how what is current staffing compared to need and how is that gonna change miss Holton I'm gonna say the same thing we provided a staffing plan and a support plan to the General Assembly as they requested and we have five current staffing positions

[02:51:27] available and posted on the website thank you that still doesn't tell me how the need compares and I just will submit that the past studies have shown that we're understaffed so are those five matching the need that we've heard accounted under the current system and the future system and if if you have any additional information that can address that I'd appreciate it whether from dr.

[02:51:52] Elbin or otherwise if if not I'll move on to I have another question please proceed so am I right that Heidenwood school I'm just looking at their school quality profile and it looks like the work you all have done with them has paid off they've made some major progress on their test scores in some cases moving you know 10% or more forward despite having still high levels of inexperienced teachers and provisionally licensed teachers as all of our higher poverty schools have most of our higher poverty schools have but am I right that their SOL scores are all still well below 60% they're going to

[02:52:30] be rated as a failure under the new system am I right the Heidenwood elementary under their new as long their SOL scores are all 55% or below they're going to be rated as off-track or need intensive support under the new system based on those scores is that right Dr. Coons Miss Holton you said that I'm sorry I missed the fact in the statistic that you mentioned you said that most of our high poverty schools have provisionally or unlicensed teachers can you tell me the source of that data that you just quoted yeah the school quality profiles provide data on inexperienced teacher rates and the

[02:53:09] provisional licensee rates and they're for the high poverty schools they're much higher than for and you all have done numerous studies showing us that our high poverty schools have higher rates of inexperienced and provisionally licensed teachers it's on it's on your data dashboards I'm so sorry I thought you said all high poverty schools had I may have said Paul and I should have said most thank you Dr. Alvin so the question is miss Holton a school make sure that if you'd like to speak let me know I'm sorry thank you just to repeat my question to a school with scores comparable to Heiden even if you can't

[02:53:46] speak specifically to Heidenwood a school with scores comparable to Heidenwood given that the new system doesn't credit progress in any way school level progress am I right that despite moving test scores significantly forward if they're still 57 percent or less pass rates they're going to be rated off-track or need intensive support under the new system Dr. Cairns Ms. Houlton can I ask a clarifying question you said that the new system doesn't honor progress can you clarify what that means yes as you know our

[02:54:22] current system both takes into account student growth but also school level progress so a school such as Heidenwood where starting from a low point has made significant progress on its test scores gets a credit for that within the current accountability the current accreditation system which is our current accountability system such that they might be level two instead of level three if they've made demonstrated sufficient progress from last year's rate to this year's rate that progress piece is is gone from the new proposed

[02:55:01] system as I understand it dr. Coons I believe that that would be what we consider part of the growth for him work but I'd be happy to have Chad speak to that when he gets here but my understanding is is that we absolutely measure expected growth and that's called out in this system much more clearly than it was in the past so maybe when we get to Hilton thank thank you so I'm sorry maybe maybe when we get to the presentation D Chad and and can tell me am I right that a school like Heidenwood would be rated off-track or

[02:55:38] needs intensive support with the numbers that we've seen for it despite moving from way below 10 20 points up but not yet making the proficiency cuts understood Mr. Rotherham yeah I'm confused madame president I feel like we've lost the thread here is the argument that we're not doing enough or that we're doing too much because I would assume if a parent if I'm you're gonna be very happy with that progress if you've moved but if you still only have a pass rate of 57% most parents are gonna want as much support as they could possibly get if we could possibly provide I generally share the concern to make sure we can

[02:56:17] actually do enough and that our means are aligned with our appetite to do as much as we need to do to address the challenges that we're seeing across the Commonwealth. But it seems like we'll want to recognize that progress and that'll be apparent in the school profile and so forth. But if I'm a parent of a school with only 57% of kids passing USL, particularly at the current SOL pass rates, I'm going to be pretty concerned and I'm going to want us to be throwing everything we possibly can at that to continue that improvement and i just think one of the speakers this morning was talking about sort of the adult politics i think the tier one tier two at some level that's like adults are

[02:56:55] going to worry about that parents just want to know what support is being provided what is actually going to change at this school by way of teaching and learning and and this is we don't need to delve into it but this is like is it actually meaningful or is it just peanut butter to make sure these

interventions are actually research-based and really meaningful miss madam president may May I have a respond?

[02:57:15] Ms. Holton. If there were genuine new supports involved, I'd be fine with all of it. The problem is there are effectively no new supports attached to this system. The little bit of new support that there's been has been at the General Assembly's initiative over with, frankly, the reluctant partnership from the administration and has been short-term, temporary, nowhere near the need as identified in the JLARC report which really says what the research says which is our high poverty schools need 30 to 50 percent

[02:57:52] more per student and that just there's nothing no proposals on the table that I have yet seen and hopefully maybe the governor's proposals budget proposals that we'll see for the next session in in December will include some dramatic increase of supports but so far what I can tell is we've got plenty of need identified and no new support perhaps his his budget will identify that but we'll see that miss Ashton I would just like to be clear on the action and discussion we're having this is a presentation I want to also just provide

[02:58:31] make sure I'm understanding where we are you asked the team to come back to us and really clarify the tiers and the levels of supports and to use some real examples around what this could look like once the framework is finalized that's what i understand this to me um which which i think the team has done that and so thank you for that um i the conversation that's happened right now is um unclear for me because we're using language that i don't think is consistent with what this board has um deliberated over for at least a year or so

[02:59:09] that I've been on here, which is, we want greater transparency. We want clarity around where our schools are, a true picture of school performance. I think what is concerning to me about this conversation is, again, this is as a school leader, we know that there are schools that are doing well, and there are students who are doing well in the state of Virginia.

[02:59:38] No one is denying that. What this framework is allowing us to understand is which students and which teachers and which school divisions are really doing well, how can we learn from them, and which students and which teachers are not, and how do we give them some more resources.

[02:59:55] I agree, Ms. Holton, about, you know, we need to make sure that the right resources are going to the right schools in need, whether it is the students and families who need the most resources. And my response is what we are hearing right now is a framework to ensure that those resources go to the schools that are most in need.

[03:00:21] And so I would love to move this conversation forward. If there is more information that is needed about tier one, tier two, tier three, how we're determining the resources and support, then I would move that we have, give that feedback to the team.

[03:00:37] But otherwise, I think that we are rehashing and asking questions that have been asked and I would like for us to move forward so we can have a more fruitful conversation around what's next in terms of setting up our teachers, our school divisions in the state of Virginia up for success as school is open.

[03:01:02] - Dr. Brey? - I wanted to bring this back to Heidenwood Elementary. I, like Ms. Holton, applaud Hydenwood Elementary and the Office of School Quality for the support that they gave here so that we could see real improvement in that school.

[03:01:18] That's wonderful news. I think it would be irresponsible to see improvement there and then think that we don't need to continue to give support to that school. If the school continues to be labeled as off track, that only means that we continue to give, my understanding is that that means that we continue give them the support that has already been effective so I guess I'm unclear as to why that would be a bad thing all right on the next slide as the board is aware the new regulations guiding accreditation have laid out more concrete steps for school divisions local boards to be required to enter a

[03:01:57] memorandum of understanding with the Board of Education if a division has several schools identified for federal support this becomes the tipping point that shifts from school-specific support to a division-wide approach for support. Because superintendents supervise, lead, and have authority over the entire division and its schools, VDOE executes an MOU with the division and that school board that requires greater accountability for addressing the needs in their division and comprehensive support in order to significantly improve outcomes for students. These include essential actions with a corrective action plan

[03:02:35] for the division including supporting divisions with staffing requests and applicants financial support on expenditures and supporting divisions with curriculum and intervention implementation the office of school quality checks in with these divisions frequently to assess progress and their needed levels of support here you'll see a timeline on the next slide looking over the next year this information comes to the board as a primer the september board meeting where a revised mou template and its processes will be presented for first review many of the adaptations will be

[03:03:12] aligned to already approved changes in the revised standards of accreditation in october the board will have a second review of the revised mou template this approval will thus require the five existing school divisions with an MOU to implement a revised MOU for the remainder of the year starting in January based on notification that they will receive in November in the summer the MOU divisions will present to the board their data and plans for improvement and then finally in September 2025 based on the 2024 2025 school performance data there will be a

[03:03:49] determination of which of the school divisions may exit the MOU status in which new divisions will need to enter into an MOU with the Board of Education thank you for your time today madam president miss Holt a question as to the if you can go back to slide 11 this is just an informational question but can you help me understand is anything changing about the criteria for schools divisions entering into MOU status or is this this description in slide 11 is that what our current process is and that's just you're just reminding us

[03:04:29] that that's continuing Dr. Gaines no our current process does not have criteria to put schools or to work with schools on an MOU process this was voted in the regulatory process to that at least 40% of the schools identified in a school division for comprehensive support or a TSI or a school division that has 10 or more schools identified for CSI as a new part of the regulations that has been approved so that's in if I'm president now miss Holton so that the the regs that

[03:05:01] we finalized last month provide that depth those criteria for entering into MOU status that's new language in the in the regs we just approved is that right yeah dr. Coons is that right yes and and is it the 10 or more is it well is it Shall or may, if you're 40% or 10% or more.

[03:05:29] So my question would be, and I apologize that I missed that when we adopted the regulations, but 10 or more schools is different whether you're in Galax or in Fairfax or Virginia Beach.

[03:05:46] So Galax, well, has three or four schools altogether. Fairfax has 200. Virginia Beach has 100. So for Fairfax to qualify for an MOU, just 10 schools, that would be 5% of their schools, would qualify them for an MOU.

[03:06:05] Likewise, Virginia Beach, 10% of their schools. That's correct. Okay. Does that make sense? Who are you asking that question to?

[03:06:23] To Ms. Cooper or Dr. Koons, if she prefers. What? Dr. Koons? I think this is the similar philosophy to lowering the end size. If we ensure our students are getting earlier support, as Ms. Ashton spoke to, then we can understand what they need and make sure that we can provide them the support.

[03:06:41] The MOU process is to provide extensive support for school divisions who have a number of schools that are struggling or 40% of their schools. That has been part of the regulatory process since we had conversations almost a year ago and part of multiple public comment pieces.

[03:06:59] Mr. Rotherham. Yes, I mean, I think that this is going to be one of these crux things. If we go back to the battle days of No Child Left Behind, everybody was for accountability. Actually, Senator Evan Bayh, a Democrat from Indiana, had a very prophetic line, my friend Dr. Hansel, remember, where he said when the law was passed, he said, everyone's going to love accountability right up until it's put in place and applied to them.

[03:07:25] And that was completely prophetic. That's exactly what happened. And the appetite evaporated. And part of the reason it evaporated is you had a lot of school districts that like to say how well they were doing but as soon as you disaggregated the data you found out black kids Hispanic kids kids with special needs were lagging far behind we're gonna replay that same basic dynamic where you look at our data and people talk about with averages when you actually look underneath it we have all these all these subgroups so I don't have a problem with a large division coming into an MOU and I'll talk about the MOU in a second with ten schools we just need to make sure that people actually understand what is going on and

[03:08:04] and why and this again gets back to are we gonna be most concerned with adults and reputational things and public relations and divisions don't want to have an MOU are we gonna be most concerned with if you've got ten schools where you've got particularly large achievement gaps and so forth are we actually gonna be forthright and serious about that I think that's on all of us we should all know what we're signing up for my concern on the MOUs I found public comment this morning quite surreal um with all this talk about privatization and so forth if you look at the record of mous in this commonwealth nothing happens right like if if people want to be in here banging the drums for equity they should be asking why we've had

[03:08:43] divisions in mous for two decades and nothing has happened and those are our most vulnerable kids that has been traditionally the problem and my concern is i'm not sure what we've done to actually change that and that's not on us that's there's there's legal and constitutional apparatus in the state but we're having this crazy conversation about privatization all these other buzzwords to get everybody spun up but are absolutely like meaningless in this conversation and we're not talking about like with these mous how are they actually going to be meaningful we're not going to have sort of the traditional thing we've done where we give them a warning and then we give them

[03:09:19] maybe a slightly sterner warning when when they don't get results and that how are we actually going to drive change and and there's been precious little attention particularly in the public dialogue uh to that question i think i just want to note i mean i'm excited about this and so forth but like there is a lot of work to be done here if we're gonna make this um if we're gonna make this real i would like to think about if there's ways dr coons where we can have regular updates like this on what's happening you mentioned that you know we're hiring which is exciting in five new positions if we could have it a regular cadence of board meetings updates on sort of the support what's happening anything we're learning you know wins that were that

[03:09:58] we're seeing and so forth and things that we're gonna do differently because this is I mean this this is this is the crux of it and again this morning was surreal because the gap between the rhetoric and what actually happens is is stark and we and we need to be attentive to that thank you dr. Coons mr. Rotherham I was speaking to one of our current MOU school divisions who has a new superintendent and as she walked through classrooms it was shocking to her that the teachers weren't not even aware that the school division was under MOU so I think there's a transparency and a communication piece that is really lacking in the way in which we communicate not only to our families and

[03:10:38] our children but our teachers as well so and mentioned that we will be having the MOU current school divisions come and present at the end of next year and And as we are looking at the MOU status, we are looking at much more frequent communications to families, communications to the board, communications to local board, and making sure there's much greater transparency and connective tissue around those supports and the results of those supports.

[03:11:05] So I appreciate that recommendation. Thank you. Dr. Kins. Mr. Rotherham. Thank you for that. And I should have said, first of all, as soon as I say the board, we'd like regular updates that you guys are probably like that guy. So I apologize. I apologize in advance for that. um but i think it would be really helpful and i would be remiss we jumped right in and not saying like the whole presentation this morning this is great work and i know you guys there's a lot

[03:11:26] of pieces here and i'm extremely extremely appreciative of that miss mcpherson over two

[03:11:55] thirds of students were at risk were at risk or failed their math sol we also black and hispanic students have experienced a significant decline in math and we've taken into consideration the pandemic but it looks like there's been a drop of almost 20 percentage points now i mean to the governor's credit and the state's credit about the all-in program which has helped improve as far as math and reading is concerned after the pandemic we just have serious issues that have to be

[03:12:34] addressed and trying to define exactly where those problems exist and how we approach those issues and provided support is going to be extremely important going forward. Again, we'll need to take a look at any school that moves into an MOU status and also come back and continue to analyze their progress.

[03:12:58] And I think that's where growth and progress will become very important in terms of the communication. But parents are concerned about the fact that we need to move to a system that provides clear transparency and that we begin to deal with accountability so that we leave no child behind.

[03:13:21] And that will bring up the issue of moving from the 30 to the 15 students and the cutoff point because we really need to know what's going on with every single student. And anything that we can do to

help us better understand that and provide support for that is going to make a serious difference.

[03:13:38] So I think we all need to be all in on what can we do to improve our system give credit to our teachers and our principals but doing all that they can at this point but we'll call the pundits at the standard and and that calling is a high calling and we all need to reach for that okay good all right I know we are supposed to move into item D right now but I'd like to take item E first and then we'll break for lunch and go

[03:14:16] back to item D please so item E sorry Dr. Raley is that you thank you should have given you a better heads up there I'm trying to deal with our timing Madam President members of the board last month you had the opportunity to see some recommended school bus specifications and that was a process that went through several iterations with practitioners in the field parents and the goal of those school bus specifications is to provide greater clarity when options and alternatives may be available to our local school divisions and other individuals impacted

[03:14:56] by those specifications just one to provide a lot more transparency and clarity so the individuals can make good decisions for the benefit of their community I presented to you today for second read and recommend approval is there a motion to approve the proposed revisions to the Virginia public school bus specifications as presented in this item second okay the motion has been made and properly seconded is there any discussion hearing none mr. Hanson

[03:15:30] Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Bryce? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. And chair votes aye. Let's see. Why don't we take item F, too, if we don't mind? Oh, well, we'll do it. We'll go. Okay. Items before we take lunch.

[03:16:37] On item F, the Board of Education approved courses to satisfy graduation requirements for the standard advanced studies and modified standard diplomas in Virginia public schools is a document which schools use to determine which courses have been approved to satisfy

[03:17:16] course requirements for standard and advanced diplomas. This document contains technical edits, changes to SCED codes, which are the school courses the exchange of data that align to the national code database and clarifying language regarding provisions in economics and personal finance for students with disabilities. Additionally, minor edits have been made for improved accuracy, readability, and formatting.

[03:17:43] One major change to this document is the allowance of substitute courses to satisfy physical education requirements for 9th and 10th grade students seeking a standard or advanced diploma. The proposed changes would allow JROTC and/or unified PE to be substitute courses to meet the PE graduation requirements. The JROTC substitution is a result of House Bill 98 which passed in the most recent legislative session. Teachers of these courses must ensure that physical education standards of learning are taught in these courses and that

[03:18:20] students also take health and driver's ed. As you heard in public comment last month and today, Raina Lateef, president of Matchup, has advocated for unified PE, which is currently an elective course in the 11th and 12th grades to be a substitute course. Permitting unified PE as a substitute for the PE requirements would give divisions the flexibility for students to meet PE requirements by taking the course in 9th and 10th grade, thus opening up further elective opportunities for students in 11th and 12th grades. Unified PE provides

[03:18:56] opportunities for students with and without disabilities to engage in activities designed to break down barriers, promote acceptance and understanding, and create a more inclusive school environment. Students work together to participate in individual or team competitions or events. I want to note that unified PE is not a replacement for adapted physical education, but rather a complimentary program.

[03:19:22] Adapted PE is a legally mandated, customized program designed to meet the unique needs of students with disabilities. It ensures these students receive the same benefits of PE as their peers with the modifications and accommodations outlined in their IEP.

[03:19:38] The specialized instruction is required by IDEA. The Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board of Education approve the Board of Education approved courses to satisfy graduation requirements for the standard, advanced studies, and modified standard diplomas in Virginia public schools.

[03:19:57] Is there a motion to approve the proposed updates to the Board of Education approved courses to satisfy graduation requirements for the standard, advanced studies, and modified standard diplomas in Virginia public schools? So moved. Second. Is there a new discussion?

[03:20:17] Hearing none, Mr. Hansen? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Bryce? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? miss mcpherson hi miss holton hi and chair votes aye um let's see mr chapman do you want to take

[03:20:39] uh g thank you to president creasy vice president hanson members of the board and superintendent koons this action is similar to what was presented last month for the board what we are looking to do

[03:21:17] is to finalize some of the periodic reviews that the board authorized for the department to open back in december of 2023 we had opened those in a few different phases and so this is concluding um i think about two-thirds of those we have another batch where public comment just closed on august 5th we expect those to be coming those results be coming to the board soon enough so we have three chapters that we're looking to close out the periodic reviews um one of those is the regulations governing people accounting records where the you know staff found that this is a regulatory chapter that's still required by statute, and BDOA staff recommends that it be retained as is.

[03:21:56] We have the regulations governing the testing of sight and hearing of pupils. This is also a chapter that's required by statute, and we recommend that the underlying policy be retained as is, but we do recommend that in the future the Board consider combining this with Chapter 690, since both of these chapters serve the same end users.

[03:22:18] And so we think that for administrative convenience, this might be better for the field. And then the last chapter is the regulations governing the school lunch sale of food items. This chapter appears to be outdated, no longer in use. It has not been updated since 1980.

[03:22:34] We received one comment on that chapter that was beyond the scope of the regulatory review or the periodic review, but VDO staff has consulted with OEG recommend that this chapter be repealed. Again, this action is not to start any regulatory actions.

[03:22:49] This is just to close out the periodic reviews. Any regulatory actions resulting from this to move the chapter 250 on the testing of sight and hearing of pupils or to repeal the lunch sale of food items, those regulations would come in a separate action.

[03:23:05] We're just looking to close out the results of the periodic reviews. The recommendation is that the board waive first review and approve this item. Is there a motion to waive first review and approve the closing of the periodic reviews on the regulatory chapters identified and presented to the board in this item?

[03:23:23] Second. Is there any discussion? Mr. Hansen? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Bryce? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye.

[03:23:38] Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Houlton? And chair votes aye. Okay, the last one we'll take, I promise, is Mr. Gilstrap, and then we'll do lunch.

[03:24:04] Good afternoon, President Greasy, members of the board, Dr. Coons. Today I bring to you a first and final review of action on the one-year local eligibility license. As you might remember on July 25th the Board of Education approved an exempt action regarding a regulatory change to implement chapter 845. The chapter allows the board to authorize school board authorize each school board upon recommendation of the division superintendent or the school board and in accordance with the criteria set forth in the bill to issue a one-year non-renewable local eligibility license

[03:24:42] this is only valid in the issuing school division the requirements are in your board packet and the expiration date for this action is July 1st 2030 2030 since that presentation in July the VDOE has received direction from the Office of Regulatory Management yet the implementation of the chapter 845 does not strictly require regulations by withdrawing the action the board will allow for efficient and more flexible school division implementation with this action school divisions can use this legislation to fill vacancies for the

[03:25:22] 24/25 school year superintendent public instruction recommends that the board of education withdraw the regulatory action regarding chapter 845 of the 2024 acts of the assembly that was approved in July is there a motion to withdraw the regulatory action regarding chapter 845 of the 2024 acts of assembly that was approved

[03:25:49] at the july 25th 2024 meeting of the board okay the motion has been made and seconded is there any discussion of this item hearing none mr hansen hi miss kilgore ah miss ashton dr bryce hi mr rotherham hi miss mcpherson hi miss holton and chair votes aye okay we will take lunch until

[03:26:21] I don't know 105 okay we are back and we are starting with item D and I believe

[04:08:55] that is Chan and add the dynamic duo yes I'm gonna be kicking us off today thank you so much president Creasy and so probably not surprised to see us again but um we are have a agenda today I think a few key purposes a key few key decisions building off of the July board meeting as you can see on the second slide sort of the key things that we'll be reviewing today include once again reiterating the vision and guiding principles behind why we are taking undertaking this work also doing sort of an overview of key decisions and the

[04:09:32] timeline an overview of the new system under the regulations that you approved last month and then providing some new additional framework modeling this is all leading up to three votes one vote

focused on the readiness indicators and and waiting the second related to the draft uh s estate plan and then the third is a overview of the school support school performance and support framework um as we start all of these conversations and has as we have for the last uh at least a year um if not more just rooting this in the overall

[04:10:09] guiding principles behind this work which you can find on the third slide again sort of the north star behind everything here is that we want to have high expectations for every student we also want this system to be transparent and result in actual information that all stakeholders can use that's educators parents community members and really focus on getting students to those high expectations while also recognizing the growth that they are making and it's something I'll talk about in a little bit on a few of our later slides that stakeholder input would critical in building this system and really engaging in public feedback and public comment

[04:10:46] all along the way so i've mentioned a few times that we have been frequent guests before the board and as you can see on slide four just a little bit of an overview of where we have been and where we are going and i can now firmly say we're not sort of at the beginning stages of this process because we have been working for years having conversations with the board around the principles behind this new school support and performance framework collecting stakeholder feedback going through the regulatory process going through additional rounds of stakeholder feedback and here we are in the summer

[04:11:24] of 2024 standing ready with amendments to the draft state plan under ESSA that we will be reviewing and hopefully approving later today that's then going to be leading into the 24/25 school year this year it's underway collecting data So that the system is actually operational next fall and can be fully implemented on slide five as just the overview again like grounding what this new system will look like under the new regulations and that is really

[04:12:00] bifurcating the process of school accountability from school accreditation and Having an accreditation system that is really focused on inputs and compliance with the statutory requirements in Virginia all eight components of the SOA and which includes accountability components but also includes class sizes and graduation requirements and all of the things that are so critical and that's still going to exist but it's going to exist separate and apart from the new school performance and support framework which as we've discussed many times is rooted in the elementary and middle

[04:12:35] school level and three key buckets of it measures growth readiness and mastery and in high schools focused on mastery readiness and graduation that then feeds into this multi-measure system producing an overall category for every school that's clear transparent and doing a better job of really differentiating good from great and that also is now I think a new key feature of this system that we've talked about many times I know Dr. Coons has talked about many times is that it is aligned with the federal requirements so we will no longer have

[04:13:11] a list of schools that need support under the federal rules and a school list of schools that need support under the state rules. We will have one unified list of schools that need additional support to help their students so that, as Dr. Cooper presented earlier, the Office of School Quality can really streamline and make the supports of the range of schools much more consistent and efficient so with that diving into the on slide six some of the latest public comment that we got particularly on that s estate plan which

[04:13:49] is I would say one level deeper than the regulations that you all approved last month the s estate plan the proposed redline text to that was posted for public comment for 30 days, starting on July

25th and ending on August 24th. The department received roughly 70 comments from all across the Commonwealth and from a diverse range of audiences.

[04:14:16] That includes parents, school board members, community organizations, and leaders, educators, and other stakeholders. The most bulk of the comments, nearly two-thirds of them, were supportive of the changes that were in the draft ESSA plan and they were on a range of topics I would say most of which probably are not surprising because they are the same topics that you have been debating as a board for the last several years so some of the comments particularly on chronic absenteeism the advanced coursework measure for middle schools the weighting of the mastery index overall were very supportive we also had many supportive comments about

[04:14:55] the language that was used to communicate school performance um and i would say overall there were probably more divided comments around some of the key changes that were brought up earlier around the reporting group size for students or n size um is it sometimes called and then the length of uh time under which english learners should be included we heard in favor uh from folks in favor of both of those changes, that the enhanced reporting and visibility of these student groups is critical to ensuring that schools that serve those student populations receive

[04:15:30] the support they need in a timely fashion, rather than before it has been later to intervene and sort of those problems have escalated and have potentially gotten worse. And I would just say overall, in addition to this public comment process, the VDOE team was also in conversation with the folks at the U.S. Department of Education, getting feedback from them on some key components and key changes in the plan to be sure that the team was on the right track in terms of being sure that this plan would be approved by the U.S. Department of

[04:16:06] Education. And so some of the changes that were made were not just in response to the public comment, but directly in response to things that the U.S. Department of Education raised. We'll stop there and see if there are any questions before we move to the next section.

[04:16:23] all right Chad hi so I'm gonna start talking today about the modeling update that we've done on the school performance and support framework I want to start by framing some conversation of what it is and what we've been talking about so we heard in the public comment today some comments about whether this is just about identifying schools or calling them failures and I want to be clear that we've purposely called it a school performance and support framework

[04:17:03] the board has made clear it's not an A through F system there's no use of the word failure no school is a failure we're not giving up on schools it's about finding the schools that need more support and trying to align and streamlining those supports that the video he has to support those schools on slide it's my numbers slide eight and nine show the results of two of the models this we in July we presented the results of model three that we've done

[04:17:41] three different models using the contractor SAS so as a reminder SAS was contracted to help run the numbers and model the system out and the purpose of those models is to test the inclusion of various components to make sure the pieces fit together we also tested different measures of the number of students to be included for a student group. We also tested the weighting of the English learner progress metric as well. I also want to remind you that this is all anonymized so I can't answer any questions about specific schools. We didn't want to pick favorites. We wanted to look how the system was working not

[04:18:19] for individual schools. So on slide 8 is a reiteration of something I showed you at the last one. The results from the July Model 3 and we talked last time those results were the 22-23 data and if you turn to slide nine shows the results of model 4 using the 23-24 school year I also want to point out that include some of the big topics that we've been discussing so the change to include English learners that were recently arrived the old state accreditation

[04:18:57] system excluded English learners for up to 11 semesters five and a half years that's not allowed under the federal rules and Virginia under the federal system has been using a shorter period and that's what is going to be included in this it's been included in all the models it will include about 35,000 English learners that were being excluded under this state accreditation system I also want to say it's not on here but thanks to investments that Virginia's made and some of the progress the indicator level metrics rose by a couple points for almost every single indicator that's included in the

[04:19:34] system. So it's heartening that progress is showing up in here. More students are mastering more topics. They're moving up the scale on going from below basic to basic and basic to proficient. They're also improving on things like chronic absenteeism and consistent attendance. The other thing I'll say for now is that VDOE is planning a Model 5. So this is the Model 4 results, but the Model 5 will be to share those results privately with divisions so they can see how their schools are performing and they can confirm that they are matching up with

[04:20:12] their own data and they can also start to understand it going forward so with that I'm gonna turn it over to miss Cooper to talk about the supports and build on the presentation earlier madam president this all the questions for mr. alderman yes thanks thank you Chad looking at slide 9 which is the model four data it says this is based on partially modeled data what's not yet taken into account in this model the partial yeah the big one for this is the

[04:20:49] high school of the 3e indicator of the transition from the old CCCRI to the 3e indicator we've been working on collecting that data and making sure it's ready for model five. So we used CCRI data as approximation for the E3? For this model, we actually pulled it out. So it's the high schools were evaluated without that metric. Okay. Am I right that it also does not reflect the lowering by one category for all the TSI schools? That's

[04:21:24] correct, yes. And am I right that we have about 200, typically 200 TSI schools? Yeah, it's not on here, but in July, it was about 20% of schools were identified for the TSI. 20%, wow. So that's more than, that's closer to 300. Some of this would already be captured in the components here, but it's, yeah, it's 20%.

[04:21:44] So I'm assuming, am I right in assuming that needs intensive support is pretty well, those 58 schools under the needs intensive support are pretty well aligned with the CSI schools? Yes, there's a little bit of Venn diagram, but it's very similar overlap here.

[04:22:02] so miss holton i would remind you i'm sorry business meeting and not a work session so continue to to ask questions through the chair okay i apologize um may i ask another question please um am i right then that puts i was thinking a couple of hundred tsi schools is what we've had in the past but i'm hearing you say it may be even more than that schools are going to have their category bumped down one and therefore that instead of and that those schools are all currently in distinguished on track or off track

[04:22:41] they're not in needs intensive support so instead of 916 schools being off track it's really probably going to be a thousand or more and meanwhile some schools moving from the off track to the needs in other words we're gonna have a hundred or more schools bumped from one category to the next once we do the TSI adjustment dr. Coons I think we're making assumptions before we have data so I caution us to make assumptions without that information because a lot of those schools may already be in their categories

[04:23:15] Madam President can I ask mr. alderman for an answer to that question mr. alderman yeah the short answer is that there probably will be some movement across categories and and just judging by the number of TSI schools we're talking about probably a hundred extra, you said 20% of the schools are TSI, so of that 900 off-track, a hundred or more of them are going to move into needs intensive support, and a hundred or more on-tracks are going to move into off-track, assuming that performance is roughly what it was this year. Yeah, I don't have the exact numbers for you, but that's not out of the question.

[04:23:53] So we're going to be going from 900 some schools off-track or needs intensive support to 1200 or so in between those two categories I think you asked the same question twice and mr. Alderman answered it I think it would be mr. Rotherham I think it'd be could could you explain Chad that why I think for people watching and maybe for the board it's confusing why the federally identified schools the TSI schools why that would why that would move the number and why

[04:24:30] that system would be different yeah so the what's presented on here is the overall score for the school including all students what miss holton is asking me about is the categories of schools that are called targeted support improvement those are schools that have a particular student group that is as low performing as the bottom five percent of schools overall and so in the regulation that the board has passed and the is now final it says that uh schools that are in that category will have their category lowered by one so a school that is identified as a targeted support school is lowered. We don't have the

[04:25:09] final numbers for you today, but it is potential that schools would change a little bit across those different categories. The other thing I'll say is so this is presentation for the board, this is not final, this is not something that would go on report cards at this point in time. There's still a long journey to develop those and what that looks like and how to display that information as fall. But Chad, am I correct in saying in plain English, if a school is getting triggered under the federal accountability system, it means it's got a subgroup that's as low as the lowest performing across the state, and we are triggering that so that they then get more attention. Is that

[04:25:48] the plain English version of what we're talking about? That's right. So it would be a school that has a student group, say students with disabilities, or black students, or Hispanic students, or low income students, that are performing on their own as low as the bottom 5% of schools. And so that is called the targeted support and they are federally identified and they are eligible for federal resources as well the Virginia has 7% of its title 1 money which can be used to support those targeted support and what are called comprehensive support which are the overall schools that are struggling

[04:26:22] overall. Madam President. Ms. Halton. But Mr. Alderman part of what we're using I hope what we're using this modeling system for is to make plans for the support that these schools are going to need so it is relevant to that calculation isn't it to have some reasonable estimate of how many schools are going to need support at what level and I'm looking at this TSI information adding in going from what's now a large number 55% as off-track or needs

[04:26:58] intensive support actually going to 70% or higher wouldn't that be a factor that that we need to model in now so that we can prepare for supports yeah that's actually a nice segue to the next slide if you're ready for that it's about how we braid and support school is based on their miss Ashton has a question I want to clarify miss Holton's question she said could you just state again you said aren't we supposed to be deciding how we are going to support schools and I

[04:27:37] i thought this was a framework to determine who needs support and those are two two different things so this is telling us who and there's another step in the process that says how and so i but maybe chad actually i would actually prefer you go ahead to the next slide um because i think that might get to who and how being two different things i'll just say i think that's a helpful framing so to identify which schools need support and then the conversation that we had this morning about how they'll be support and also transitions

[04:28:11] nicely to Ms. Cooper is going to talk about how that works as well thank you so you know as a teaching and learning team we're implementing an academic strategy across the state then our assessment gives us data on how well our students are performing and which schools need support and that data informs future iterations of that strategy and the supports that are needed across schools So as I shared earlier, our comprehensive support plan supports a robust system that meets the various needs and complexities of every school.

[04:28:46] And in teaching and learning, there are tiers of supports, like I shared earlier. So similar to how our students have different needs and require individualized supports, our schools also have different needs and require individualized support. So we have those three tiers of supports, tiers one, two, and three, and then school systems who have persistently struggled with a number of schools then receive additional support through an MOU.

[04:29:09] So, again, various supports for all schools in tier one, then more targeted support in tier two, and then really intense comprehensive supports for tier three in our MOU divisions.

[04:29:30] I'm going to move ahead to slide 13 and talk through the board's decisions today. A lot of them are things that we had first review in July, and we're going to circle back to them today. Mr. Rotherham? Before we get to 13, can we pause on slide 11, though? Yes.

[04:29:47] You want me to go through that? Yeah. Mr. Rotherham? I think it's important. Thank you, President. I think it's important. I mean, I've been someone who, throughout this whole process, has said, like, we should not be trying to game what do we want this to look like. We should be looking at what do we want kids to be able to do, and then fact mapping from that.

[04:30:06] And I will remind everybody, and again, like, this morning I found surreal. This is a state where 60% of our black students, for instance, are below basic on the NAEP. And so people come in here and are like, oh my gosh, we're going to like, we're trying to make, you know, Governor Youngkin's like cooking this up. 60% below basic.

[04:30:23] The commissioner of education statistics stood before us and said, that means you are fundamentally unprepared for opportunity in our society. That's not like a made-up standard or something. That is below basic on the NAEP, 60%. And so I expect we're going to see any meaningful system.

[04:30:40] we're gonna see large numbers and one of the speakers talked about Maryland and they had numbers that were more modest than the governor there still you know calling for pretty pretty dramatic change so all that said so I expect to see large numbers if we're if we're being honest about this it's it's unavoidable but I am this like is there really only one middle school that's that's what I want to talk to you on 11 because I want to make sure we're being really careful it's entirely possible that is the case especially given we know about middle schools and their struggles and it's really difficult period that is but I just

[04:31:13] want to make sure we really feel confident because that that did catch my eye and that could be that the story here there is a lot of news that people have not been told and so it's going to be a shock to the system and we're already sort of starting to see some of that play out but it could also be are we sure we're confident and is there anything we should be paying attention to and I'll just say the thing some people are going to immediately go to this just shows that it's it's a bad it's not right and I don't think we I don't think we can say that again given that data we can go through the eighth grade data that I just gave you know when you're looking at a system like that with those kind of

[04:31:52] outcomes for poor kids Hispanic kids black kids special ed kids I'm not surprised but I just want to make sure and just pause on pause on this slide because I did catch my eye yeah I don't know if any other board members want to comment or question. I will say a couple things. One is this is the partly the result of using one scale for all the grade bands and it matters which indicators are included. And as I was going to mention to talk through later is that we've made some changes for model five based on stakeholder

[04:32:27] feedback for the advanced math components. And those changes will essentially boost up those scores so I would expect that more middle schools would see higher scores okay but that is yes that jumped out to me as well when I prepared the data man I'll just say like I don't I don't think like these intensive support 19 schools that seems manageable and completely realistic I just want to push push on that I look forward to seeing the next seeing the next run miss Hulton so I

[04:33:07] think I just heard you say Chad that you do think it looks bears worth worth looking at and I appreciate mr. Rotherham helping us focus both on there's only one distinguished school but that the proportion of on track and off track is quite different for middle schools than elementary and high schools and I'm not sure that it is consistent with our overall sense of how strong our middle schools are I don't think that there's a sense among our educators that our middle schools are wildly failing compared to our elementary and high

[04:33:42] school so my question is are you proposing or is the administration proposing any change in the system to take this data into account I mean that's part of what we're doing here is we should be looking at the results the new accountability that's why we're doing modeling to see if it makes sense and if it's gonna guide us well in preparing for implementing the new system I mean we're gonna have only one maybe it'll go up a little bit when the changes you made but one's middle school to across the state to look at as a role model for

[04:34:16] others and we're gonna have 224 off-track compared to only 75 on track quite quite different from high schools and elementary what's what's going on and what should we change in the what should we consider changing before we finalize the system today to account for that Miss Ashton as a middle school principal I can tell you exactly what's going on in middle school it's middle

[04:34:50] school and I think that what this what I see this data I'm seeing that we're raising the expectations for our scholars to prepare them to be prepared for high school I don't think this means we change the system I think it means we identify what supports are needed to keep our scholars engaged at middle school level and then to progress to high school um i the one thing that um i just i language

[04:35:23] does matter um here and i i think we are using the word transparency a lot and loose and not all meaning the same thing and um i am not one to believe that any one of the board members or staff or the hardworking teachers or administrators across the state of Virginia is intentionally waking up every day trying to deceive the public. I'm just not that person. I think everyone's trying to be their best every single day. And what we know is that the current system is masking

[04:36:03] what's happening for individual kids, particularly our most vulnerable kids. And when I see this, middle school scholars are a group of vulnerable kids just by the natural transition from elementary to middle and so what this data says is that we have to do something more and different for our middle school kids it's one indicator as chad has just indicated and we need to think differently about middle school that's what i'm taking from this and i think any middle school principal

[04:36:39] teacher and leader knows that middle school is special, and I think what transparency means is we know what is happening for individual kids, particularly our most vulnerable, and that school divisions and teachers can allocate the resources the way that they need for the students and families who need us the most, and that parents have transparency on exactly where their scholars are performing so that they can also be their best advocate. And I think what you've outlined

[04:37:18] here is giving us the tools to begin to have that conversation, and I appreciate this first attempt to show what this would look like. Yeah, from what I'm hearing from the board is that we will continue to revisit this and potentially update the board on results going forward and keep working towards this and informing it I do think the middle school advanced math component will change things in the positive direction and I'll talk about those a little bit the slide I want to point you

[04:37:54] to next is slide 13 of what we're going to be actually deciding today we're not going to decide on things like the percentage of schools in different categories. It's setting up a little bit higher level of framework. So number one is related to attachment one. It's the edits and updates to Virginia's state ESSA plan. ESSA is the Every Student Succeeds Act. Every state for exchange for federal money has to have a plan. This will be Virginia's seventh amended plan. So those plans can change as well over time, but this will be sort of

[04:38:26] creating the system for year one going forward. The attachment two is the items number two through four. They're setting up the readiness components for what will be included in year one and year two going forward. For the items in year two it's more like a blueprint and direction from the board of keep working towards those things. Attachment three is a communications document about the overall school performance and support school performance and support framework about we've heard from the board about messaging this it's a complicated change there's a lot of misinformation in the field so trying to help the field

[04:39:06] understand what the system entails the slide 14 shows the readiness components of the phase-in process of what's going to be included in year one which will be the 24 25 school year and then what would be potentially in year two which would be the 25-26 school year. At the elementary level it will be

chronic absenteeism in year one and a plan to pilot a performance task measuring five C's of multiple measures of student performance. And then in year two and

[04:39:42] beyond it would reduce the weighting of chronic absenteeism and take the five C's up to five percent. In middle school in year one it will be advanced coursework that middle school math component that I mentioned earlier and I'll dig in a little bit more later the board has expressed interest in encouraging more divisions to accelerate students who are ready there's also data presented in the every student's exact plan that the passage rates for seven six seventh and eighth graders who are taking high school level math courses is extraordinarily high and so it suggests that there may be could be more students that could have

[04:40:18] that attempt and have that opportunity and then the board has expressed interest in expanding that advancement course element to other courses and subjects over time. So that's the component there to include science and social science in year two. And then the high school level, it's a mix of chronic absenteeism, an extended year graduation rate. This is in addition to the four-year adjusted cohort measure. It's another completion metric that includes the Advanced Studies diploma, and then the Ready for Life 3E framework that we presented on in July.

[04:40:57] The next slide is slide 15, it goes through what's in the Every Student Succeed Act State Plan. I'm going to repeat some things that I said at the July board meeting. There's a few updates based on stakeholder feedback and feedback from the U.S. Department of Education that I can highlight as well.

[04:41:14] The first is that there were a lot of sections that didn't need updates, that were measuring things in the same way. That includes things like chronic absenteeism, the participation rate, and parent refusals. Those measures have not changed from the way that Virginia has done it in the past for the federal system.

[04:41:31] The same for English language progress. That metric is actually not changing in the federal system. Same with the graduation rate, it's the same as well. There are some technical edits or alignment to regulation in terms of how schools will be provided supports and what happens to them after they've been identified.

[04:41:52] The other components of the changes are more along the lines of the advanced mathematics course. So, a few things that I would say here, one, I mentioned that there are very high pass rates for sixth, seventh, and eighth graders who are taking high school level courses.

[04:42:09] So this is well beyond what they would normally take. What we've built is a new measure that would include students in 6th and 7th who are taking that course already. It's about 12,000 students across the Commonwealth who are taking that course, but aren't, divisions aren't being encouraged or boosted to encourage that.

[04:42:31] So this would incorporate them. It would also change the denominator. So we've talked at previous ones to limit the denominator to students who are scoring well in seventh grade showing that they were ready for advanced math rather than using the proficient and advanced level we limited that to just students who are scoring at advanced in seventh grade so these are seventh graders who take the seventh grade test and score at the advanced level and what we're saying is that those students should be given a shot at the high school level test in

[04:43:02] course and test in eighth grade. What else to talk through? The other thing to note is the mastery index which we've had a lot of discussions about from the board level but I just want to reiterate what's included in there. So we talked about mastery and there were some public comments this morning about mastery. It is not just the proficiency bar. We as a board decided not just to incentivize that but it's actually including performance at different levels and it more weight to students who go up and advance from below basic to basic and

[04:43:40] from basic to proficient and proficient to advance so it gives credit for schools and students all along that performance threshold. It also includes a real growth measure so Virginia's ESSA plan in the past did not have a growth measure there was no growth measure component in the Every Student Succeeds Act plan. There was growth built into the accreditation plan but it didn't include growth for students. So the way it was measured in the past in the accreditation system was a combined rate which looked at the number of students who were proficient and if they weren't proficient they added in students who made growth and if

[04:44:16] they weren't proficient or making growth they added in if they were English language learners who were making progress on English language proficiency. So those three measures got added to a combined rate and it was hard to distinguish which students were proficient, which students were making growth, which students were English language learners that needed to make progress on English language proficiency. So this will be the first time that Virginia has a standalone growth measure for all kids. I also want to say that the ESSA plan does not specify, it does specify in year one how growth will

[04:44:54] be measured. Virginia has been using the Viva system and for the past couple years and so it specifies that that will be the measure going forward. It measures whether students are meeting their expected growth over time that's if the board would like to revisit that decision we've had lots of conversations that's still a possibility for future years as well and then I'll point out that it also makes a change around the minimum student group size so this is what level of number of students does a student group count for accountability purposes and as we document in the plan it will include a lot more students

[04:45:31] because we're dropping the in size, the sample size, from 30 students to 15 students. So it will include 448 more schools will be held accountable for students with disability. That's going to include 10,000 more students with disability in accountability system across the Commonwealth. For English learners it's 216 schools and 5,607 students. For black students it's 312 schools that were not accountable for black students in the past that will be newbie accountable for those students and that's going to include 6,547 more students that weren't captured on the prior system. So the system is about

[04:46:09] transparency, about identifying students that need more supports and it's trying to be as honest and fair about that. We can talk about how other states are approaching this minimum in size as well if anyone's interested. The slide 16 shows the communications document that I mentioned. This is a framing and description for the field the board has pushed us to better communicate it's been up it's we've had as many public conversations as we can but there's probably still a lot of uncertainty and unfamiliarity with the new system so

[04:46:48] this is a communications document meant to communicate how the board has weighed and balanced the new school performance and support framework that is the end of my prepared remarks we can go for Arthur ham thank you I have a comment it's a question bear with me the n size issue seems very

important and the numbers you went through and there seems to be a lot of confusion about that and that it's

[04:47:22] some sort of gotcha or something and what it's actually doing is moving kids who are not in the accountability system you just gave some pretty staggering numbers for numbers of schools and kids that have been previously not measured they have not counted they're now moving in that's I assume unless we're different than every other state that will result in more schools being identified that is that that's yeah it is that's true it is part of the modeling that I presented to you today so there's no additional components to that but that could be a part of the reason that there are schools more off track because of that and I think I mean I think it's important that we pause on that because

[04:48:00] that is that's one of these sort of gut-check moments that we keep coming up to where we can have huge end sizes and relatively few schools will be identified and that can be comfortable or we can have hard conversations and obviously if you go too low it's you run into problems with being identifiable to particular students and that's not okay or just too much noise but can you talk about 15 because I again because because there's so much confusion I think it's worth pausing here and I completely concur with with Ms. Ashton's summation it's not that teachers are out there trying to figure out how to hide this it's that we've created a systemic system

[04:48:38] that masks this and so if you could just speak to that a little bit I think it's worth pausing on because it is it is a big consequential change in my view an overdue change but it's a consequential one yeah so that's right it's the one thing I'll say well two things I'll say one is we tested out different sample sizes in sizes for this accountability system and different models we tried 10 and we walked it back to 15 it there's no perfect answer but what we did we wanted to have a balance of identifying as many schools and students as statistically defensible but also not go too far either to get

[04:49:17] into where we're starting to identify individual students or having some privacy concerns it does mean that more schools are going to have to pay attention to more student groups and that's part of what you're seeing in the numbers the numbers that I presented on the insides are all embedded in the models and that's a big part of why the models are producing the results that they're producing Mr. Rotherham more schools having to pay attention to more groups of students that's a good thing I mean I know we feel like it's like taking medicine or something that's a good thing I don't I'm not gonna hold my breath for the headline saying that this board is now sweeping in a lot of kids who, as Ms. Ashton said, have been furthest from opportunity in this Commonwealth are

[04:49:57] now being swept into this accountability system. I'm certainly not going to hold my breath for that given the political context we operate in. But I do think, and this is for you, Dr. Kuhns, it is going to be essential that we communicate very clearly what's going on because, again, this is where there's going to be a lot of confusion.

[04:50:12] There's going to be misinformation. There's going to be that we're trying to make the system look bad and so forth, and I think it's just really essential that we communicate to educators what's going on, that we communicate to school leaders and that we as best we can communicate around the Commonwealth these numbers are going to move but they're moving for some really good reasons in terms of if you believe in transparency for kids catching kids early having a system that does that it's a really consequential change madam president dr. Brice I just want to echo that and I find the way that you all have laid it out in in the plan and attachment one where you break

[04:50:52] it down and you say exactly how many schools will be held accountable for the performance of black students and how many more students that means for being you know accounted for and and are getting the aid that they need I find that very compelling so the more that we can relay that to the schools themselves and to the teachers I think the better received this will be Ms. McPherson did you want to make a comment Mr. Rotherham just on this the last thing with this is the growth model there also seems to be a great deal of confusion about whether we had one or not I thought you did a really nice job

[04:51:30] Chad kind of walking through and that there's weights and so forth but I think this is really complicated to be again really incumbent on us to figure out some ways in very plain English to explain what's actually going on and and how it works because in the spirit of transparency it is really confusing and I think it's easy for people to be confused it's easy to understand why people would think there's not growth in the system right now I think we're going to have to really bend over backwards to make that absolutely crystal clear miss McPherson

[04:52:28] That's clearly a point where we've got to make significant progress because these students are going to be entering into high school. And if the trend of failure continues, what happens in the population is, and statistics show, that roughly 90 to 99 percent of students that don't graduate end up being incarcerated.

[04:52:50] And so, I mean, we really have got to catch the problem and deal with the problem and drive the resources exactly where they need to be and we should not be expecting that these students that are struggling and haven't had the resources are going to go into high school and the problem continues and then we end up with in society with additional problems that we still have to put money into so I think that earlier we can identify where where the resources need to be especially the new financial resources the community support the better off the entire system is going to be.

[04:53:24] Mr. Hanson? I really appreciate your comments, Dr. McPherson. And even on the spending issue, I just think we need to level set this conversation that we heard this morning and a little bit this afternoon that the United States of America spends more money of any OECD country with the exception of Luxembourg.

[04:53:46] And we exceed the average of all the OECD countries spending on education by 50%. And we spend 5.6% of our GDP on education compared to Germany at 4.5%, Japan 3.5%.

[04:54:03] And if you drill that down, you know, state by state level, Virginia's, you know, on the top half of the pack. And if you've interpolated it, you know, likewise is, you know, spending 50% more than our counterparts anywhere in the world.

[04:54:21] And if you cross-cut this with the student performance, and actually even I left the federal government 20 years ago in 2003, and as a country we were spending $16,000 plus per pupil.

[04:54:38] You fast forward 20 years to today, we're spending over $20,000 in constant dollars. So we're spending $3,500, $4,000 more per student over the last 20 years. And if you overleaf that with student performance, and the first international PISA test that was conducted was back in the early 2000s.

[04:55:00] And our reading scores at the time were 504. Fast forward 20 years, this large increase in spending, the best increase in our spending in the world, we're still exactly at 504. Math, we're at 482.

[04:55:17] Today, we're at 465. So I think to the comments of the minister about prioritizing how we spend this money, this is bringing into a change in our system to where we need to reprioritize our dollars to what Mr. Rothman was talking about earlier too at the 60% of our minority students below proficient.

[04:55:42] So in many ways, this is such a wonderful opportunity for us to change our system, bring accountability bring transparency bring innovation into this conversation and just one last money anecdote you know this last Census Bureau numbers on top of what I just said we had the largest increase I think in 40 years as a country on our public school spending last year about nine percent and that's on top of the numbers I just mentioned so I really bristle I started working on

[04:56:17] all this in 1981 and the arguments sometimes are exactly the same that it's always more money more money more money versus how do we spend our money how do we prioritize what we're doing how do we bring transparency and innovation accountability into our systems so that we can change the lives and the opportunities for students so that we don't hit what dr. McPherson was talking about with the incarceration problem and I said this back in the lab school conversation about it too that is all about the kids it's not about our system it's not about adults it's not about our bureaucracy it's about creating

[04:56:54] a system so that we can help stop this learning loss stop the achievement gaps stop the chronic absenteeism all of the challenges that we've been facing to ensure that we've got a system that works for all of Virginia's families and all of Virginia's students. Madam President? Ms. Hulton? A couple of particular questions if I may Chad the one of the things we heard at the last meeting and and through various public comment from the Chamber of Commerce and others was

[04:57:33] the importance of adding back in work-based learning which our divisions and our department staff have worked very hard on strengthening our metrics for work-based learning have we made any change to add back in the work-based learning met to the e3 metric. Yeah I would like to clarify one thing and then Dr. Coons wants to jump in as well. So one thing is that work-based learning is a part of CTE so high quality aligned work-based learning is still going to be part of the CTE component in the ready for life framework. What it doesn't

[04:58:09] include are the one-off unaligned work-based learning experiences which were potentially included in the CCCRI and so that's I don't want to I want to clarify that that is not removing all work-based learning across the Commonwealth it's just making sure that it's aligned and rigorous yeah so we met with the work-based learning coordinators we're working through the guidance that was passed in April to create consistent work-based learning experiences I spoke with a group of our regional teachers of the year about the variances and early releases and quality of work-based learning this week it was even more

[04:58:48] eye-opening than some of the comments we've had so we are working hard with our work-based learning coordinators to make sure that work-based learning is consistent and that we're giving credit for outcome-based work-based learning but not at this time. Madam President. Ms. Holton. So so just to be clear in response to the feedback we heard from the Chamber of Commerce we have not made any changes to the 3e metric to include work-based learning other than what's already included through the CTE completer process am I am I right dr.

[04:59:23] Cain's as stated miss Holton we are working through the process to ensure that we can offer high-quality bit work-based learning equitably across the state once we are able to do that we can bring that back to the board for a review again so the answer is no we're not including it we've not made any change to our plans now is that correct I don't remember the specific comment you're referring to what I

want to clarify I think at the last meeting was some implications that we were throwing out all work-based learning and that's not what's proposed here the CTE component of the employment aspect

[04:59:59] includes aligned work-based learning that's part of a CTE career and technical education sequence so as long as that is part of it and it's part of a a well-rounded rigorous CTE plan, it would still be included.

[05:00:14] Ma'am? Ms. Hulte. But I don't think-- this isn't a trick question. I don't think it's that complicated. The Chamber of Commerce and others came to us and said, our current CCRI measure includes a work-based learning metric, and it's been dropped from the 3E framework.

[05:00:31] Have we changed that since last month's draft? We have not changed it from last month. The one thing I'll remind you is that I presented data at the-- I think it was last month that students are being tracked under the current CCCRI so black and Hispanic students are more likely to be put into those unaligned not rigorous work-based learning opportunities and so they are not getting the same experience as white and Asian students who are being pushed and encouraged to follow the enrollment track and so what we're trying to do is align that and make sure that's equally rigorous we're not tracking students into different categories for

[05:01:10] different pathways for different kids. Ms. Ashton. I want to ask a different question, and I just want to confirm this. I think at either our last month or previous month, you communicated that we are developing accountability framework that we wanted to make sure was aligned with the feds.

[05:01:34] And I think what you shared today is that you were able to get that additional input from the feds, and what we have proposed is aligned and would mean that Virginia would be eligible for additional federal resources if approved, can you just confirm that?

[05:01:51] So the ESSA plan, we've had initial conversation, VDOE has had initial conversations with the U.S. Department of Education. They can't give formal approval until they see it in draft form, but VDOE will take the plan if you approve it today, submit it to the U.S. Department of Education.

[05:02:09] There's a process where the U.S. Department will review the plan and then they have a certain time limit where they have to approve it. Hopefully they don't come back to us with any additional comments. That does unlock the federal funds. So we have to have an ESSA plan in order to get Title I funds.

[05:02:27] We have one on file. This would be the new updated version of that. Madam President. Ms. Holton. Moving on to a different topic. One of the public comments we received, I believe it was from the Roanoke County Director of Assessment, pointed out that we are apparently now proposing, and I don't remember this being something we've discussed previously, weighting English language learner progress at the same level as our science SOLs under mastery.

[05:03:07] And just to be clear, our English language learners under this proposed plan will be assessed on all the SOLs content-wise with all the other students after the several semesters but in addition we're using a metric for progress on English on their English language learning specifically and that we are weighting that the same as the science SOLs we haven't talked about that is that the science SOL is given to obviously the entire

[05:03:41] school in some schools the English language learner population may be very small is that weighting appropriate and did we do any other modeling to look at other alternatives on relative weighting of science and ELL proficiency ELL progress excuse me sorry for interrupting um we actually have talked about this at a prior meeting and we uh and models one and two we experimented with different weights we tried it out at 10 percent and tried it out at 15 percent and we brought it back down to 10 percent for the system the board gave us feedback to to do that it's the

[05:04:17] same metric as under the current federal system, so it's not a new metric. Other states have a similar weighting. We're about in the middle for English language proficiency. So we did have to include it. It's part of the federal components of what's required. We also gave a presentation earlier this spring about Virginia's EL students, English learner students around the Commonwealth are not performing well. They're getting worse and doing worse than other student groups and so that's one of the reasons for the intense focus on English learner subgroup and students are students across the Commonwealth and

[05:04:54] president now miss Holton the what happens with a school so thank you for reminding me I didn't remember we'd had those previous conversations what happens with a school with a very how does this affect schools with larger versus smaller el populations assuming they're all above the n of 15 oh well if they're above the n of 15 they would be included and given a score for that metric if they're below 15 of English learner students for that school they wouldn't

[05:05:30] be given a score for that metric I mean I'm sorry to interrupt amongst those who are above you know a school that has 15 versus a school that has 300 how does this weighting affect their relative success on the in this framework it doesn't change the weighting so it's a measure of their score for English language proficiency and it doesn't change the weighting if they have more or less after they read the minimum threshold of 15 may I follow up as long as it's not repetitive because we went over that exact same thing last month I

[05:06:07] don't think it is you you asked the same question last month well I apologize if I don't remember it the the if we have a small rural school has 15 English language learners and this year's group happens to be fairly new to our country new to our language etc and does poorly isn't that going to have a disproportionate impact on that school's overall rating well it's 10% so it is enough for a school to pay attention but it's not enough to necessarily drive it

[05:06:46] from one category to the other it's also yeah I don't I don't know what to tell you it's required the federal government to include it other states are waiting it between 5 and 15 percent and so we tested the higher end we went down to a middle range for that definitely there are schools they're gonna have more challenge if they have more English learners in their school that'll be a harder task for them but that's just going to be reflected in what the data says madam president I have another topic okay there are other board members yes I'm just struggling what's the counterfactual not to include them I

[05:07:25] mean like we've been an outlier on including English language learners for a long time and now that's coming and people are like oh you know three semesters we have have under assessed and under counted English language learners for a long time that from where I said that's a like like many of these issues the basic civil rights issue in terms of kids so yes I mean I don't think there's any way around it's gonna have more it's gonna have an impact I think as Chad said it's gonna be a modest impact given how it works but I also I'm struggling with what the what's what's the counterfactual sleep it under the rug

I mean we like we have to put this out there and then communities are gonna have to say okay we have an issue here and they're gonna have to

[05:08:05] communicate and this is you know this is not something we can necessarily fix from the state level it happens at the school and classroom level but not calling attention to it and making sure people were I just don't understand how what the theory of action is of how that gets us anywhere so every one of these issues is going to create a challenge but every one of these issues is groups of kids who we were talking about who under this are not being well served I feel like that's we there that's that's again that's the the gut check we just we just have to we just have to have and we need to help communicate so people know what's going on and it does not mean that a school that's having this challenge is overall just a terrible school but it's a school that's having

[05:08:42] this challenge and we have to pay attention to those young people Ms. Ashton Madam President and fellow board members I think the team and the staff have worked incredibly hard to be responsive I have tremendous confidence in our teachers our school divisions our administrators to be able to use this data to move Virginia forward so at this point I would like to call the question in terms of this performance framework I don't think our students

[05:09:17] have any more time to waste the school year is here and teachers leaders need the clarity around direction around how to make sure that we move Virginia forward we there isn't anyone that I have heard uh in the year that I've been here that says our current accountability system is working for us so we have an accountability system we've gotten models we've gotten data and I want to also just emphasize an accountability system is not the

[05:09:50] cure-all to how we move Virginia forward we have raised standards we have um created innovative models accountability system is just one part of this and so i would move that we move forward with this accountability system um understanding that it is not perfect but that we can do hard things and come continue to collaborate get feedback to move virginia forward so i would like to call the question madam president i have one more area of questioning i'd like to do before we do that if possible is there is there yeah is there any other board member that has are there any other

[05:10:29] board members with questions or comments because this seems to be completely taken over um right i think that we risk um losing sight of what parents would like in this too um i you know when i think of these english language learners do we think that people are coming to this country and don't want their children counted in the data do we really think that they're moving here and don't want the schools held accountable for how their children are doing for, what is it, 15 semesters?

[05:10:58] I mean, of course they want their children counted. And of course they want the schools to provide the best possible education. And we want to partner with schools to do that. We want to partner with parents. Madam President. Thank you. Other board members that have not spoken.

[05:11:17] Ms. Holton, if you can do the best that you can to ensure that your questions are concise so that we can move along in our agenda. I'll do my best. Ms. Chad, in our earlier discussion, we looked at several particular schools-- Galax Elementary, Hydenwood, and a couple of schools in Chesapeake.

[05:11:43] I will posit-- and you don't need to respond to this-- but I will posit looking at those schools' performance data, all of them would, under their current circumstances, be rated off track or needs intensive support under the new system. My question to you is, and that's all after having been given the

full supports now available to Tier 2 and Tier 3 schools because these schools are already identified as needing support under our current system.

[05:12:16] Is there any proposal in our new system for additional new supports of any meaningful nature that are going to help those schools do better? What's the new support?

[05:12:32] Dr. Koons. Ms. Holton we had a whole presentation on a brand new support framework. The team provided examples of multiple supports. We have multiple pieces of funding. We have English learners. We provided 37.9 million general funds in the first year and 30.2 general funds in the second year of additional funds with additional staffing. We have additional at-risk funds that have been supported.

[05:12:59] all of those things are new monies new supports new frameworks that are being implemented as part of I hear you say the system but let's call it what it is it's the performance and support framework with a key component around support that the team has presented on multiple occasions today I didn't hear any information earlier about any new proposal for support certainly none that would be of the magnitude of supporting 70% of our schools which is what we're we're hearing are gonna be identified as off-track or needs intensive support once you take in the account the TSI ratings yeah so my final question would

[05:13:36] be is there a reason why we haven't modeled in those TSI schools is that something we could do and get a fair estimate am I right that it would be 70 percent or above once we factor in the TSI status that's information is available to you is there a reason we haven't factored that in the model for yet um i would say time is the main thing so we're trying to get the board information as quickly as we can um it's also it it we've given you uh estimates on previous models and so we didn't emphasize that uh right away we tried to give you the high level uh results um i mean the other

[05:14:16] thing is they're they're models so it's not like it has identification for any individual schools it's more like understanding how the system is working and this is model four we've had other models to provide us some evidence that it's identifying schools that need more support but several hundred schools status changing i mean that's not a small i'm sorry may i it do you have a question yes several would you agree that several hundred schools status changing is not a small change i mean that's your you said 20 we've gone over this and over this and over this mr Rotherham yeah I have a question a similar vein but it's more specific

[05:14:55] question like when we're talking about numbers of schools off track they're gonna be off track it does not mean if they if they are off track across the board they'd be a needs intensive support school so as we I mean I too am concerned to make sure we can we can help these schools in a meaningful way although I think the first step towards building a culture of doing that is by being honest about where we are so that's why I think this is this is an important step, but these off-track schools, they're going to need different things. In some cases, it's going to be relatively targeted because they're going to be off track for specific things. Every one of these schools is not going to need a comprehensive. That's my

[05:15:31] question. Is that correct? That's right. So that's why the federal system has the different categories of comprehensive support schools, which are going to be the lowest performing 5% of schools across the Commonwealth. There's going to be the targeted support schools, which are schools with a low performing student group and then there might be schools that are off track overall that are not in the bottom category they don't have a particular student group that's struggling but maybe they just need some

more tier two type of support and so this system will allow us to identify which schools need which types of support going forward okay miss Ashton yeah what I think it's

[05:16:08] important for the public to understand is that the old system identified schools in need of support and identified resources, but it didn't give schools the data that they need in order to use their resources appropriately to target the students who needed the most.

[05:16:28] For example, English language learners were excluded from that data. So I'd like to officially make a motion for the board to approve the readiness indicators in waiting the SSA state plan and the school performance framework as presented because I think Virginia's teachers leaders parents need this information in order for us to move forward so can I make that motion okay so what I how I'd like to do this though is in a couple of different ways so if I could get the board's attention on slide 14 that'll help us to frame three separate motions

[05:17:08] elementary middle and high school on the readiness waiting so bear with me here okay is there a motion to approve the elementary school readiness component waiting for the school performance and support framework second motion being made and seconded is there any discussion hearing none mr. Hanson miss Kilgore miss Ashton dr. Bryce I mr. Rotherham miss McPherson miss

[05:17:40] Holton nay and chair votes aye so second would be the middle school so is there a motion to approve the middle school readiness component waiting for the school performance and support framework the motion being made and duly seconded is there any discussion madam president there's gonna be a separate vote as to the ESSA plan overall okay thanks correct I'll save my

[05:18:08] comments for that. Any other questions or comments here? Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Bryce? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Holton? No. And chair votes aye. Is there a motion to approve the high school readiness component waiting for the school performance and support framework? So moved. Second. Motion made and seconded. Is there any discussion? Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Bryce?

[05:18:49] Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Holton? No. And chair votes aye. Okay. Speaking to Ms. Ashton's additional portion of her motion, is there a motion to approve, if you go to slide 16, that correlates here, just to help drive everybody to the right place.

[05:19:13] Is there a motion to approve the overall school performance and support framework proposal? So moved. Second. Motion being made and seconded, is there any discussion here? Yes. I'd like to comment if I may miss Olten so I know we've had a lot of discussions over this topic over a number of meetings but I would like to summarize my thoughts on as to why I am NOT able to support this current framework now I'm going to start with transparency the suggestion is that this new proposal is going to enhance transparency well I'll suggest that

[05:19:50] anybody who looks at our school quality profiles can find exactly how our English language learners for instance are doing by grade level by school down to an infinite detail and our schools have that data too the data is all out there on all of the topics we're talking about and is used to help determine schools what who's under tier 1 and tier 2 and tier 3 now it's just how those data add up to the accountability framework that's at issue so there is no It's not fair to suggest that our current system is not transparent.

[05:20:30] Our current system is still fairly new. We implemented it starting in 2018-2019, and we had several pandemic years where we weren't under normal operation, so it's still fairly new. I certainly can't say that it's perfect in every way, and I think there are some legitimate improvements that the new framework would make.

[05:20:52] I think separating out the growth measure from the proficiency measure is a good step in the right direction. I think that trying to align federal and state accountability to the best extent we can is a step in the right direction.

[05:21:07] But I think that it's fundamentally flawed in a number of ways. And I want to start with the fact that it widely ignores the feedback, the loud, persistent feedback we have heard from the beginning of when these plans were laid out back in April going forward and especially from parents from the PTA which represents thousands of parents across the state from the school board Association which represents hundreds of school board members from the superintendents Association from the teachers Association from the assessment

[05:21:43] directors in the divisions the folks who most understand this system and its implications we've heard overwhelming frustration and concerns both about being that frankly that the new proposal is wrongheaded but also not yet fully fleshed out that it's just not well thought out things like that we haven't modeled the actual system we don't know whether it's going to declare 55% of our schools failures or 70% of our schools failures that's a huge gap in our knowledge and we're just going forward way too fast with without adequate

[05:22:19] information I submit also that the new framework is simply inaccurate in declaring whether it be 55 percent or 70 percent of our schools as failures that's just not true and parents know it parents overwhelmingly report and and this administration says we want to honor parents and parents are closest to their schools and their operations and they know as widely widely evidenced in every poll that we ever see of parents and their attitude towards public schools that parents recognize that our schools have challenges they have needs we

[05:22:56] absolutely need to address them but that overall they're doing pretty darn well and as the best state for business recommend assessment from CNBC recognized and as our NAEP scores recognized even despite the talk about a so-called honesty gap we are NAEP scores though they have fallen and though they are problematic absolutely for especially for our neediest students and though we need to improve our NAEP scores are still at or above the national average on every single metric and that is simply not consistent with

[05:23:35] with a system that gives a verdict of 70% plus failure in our schools there's been a lot of discussion here about how this system is going to help identify schools that need support I would submit number one that we already have a system that identifies schools that need support as we've seen in the discussion earlier about tier 1 tier 2 tier 3 schools but I would also say that for a system to be useful in identifying schools that need support there needs to be some alignment between the the system and the available supports and I would say you know while there's been talk about an honesty gap what we really

[05:24:14] have here is a support gap and it's what we've had for a long time under different administrations and that is not something new but we have had we have consistently failed to deliver the kind of financial resources that our most challenged schools need and the oversight that they need so I'm not for blindly throwing money at problems but giving our school divisions the kinds of resources they

can use to be successful by doing things like year-round schools merit pay for teachers who are willing to serve our neediest kids intensive

[05:24:50] tutoring etc to build in long-term sustainable funding at the level identified in the JLARC report for those neediest schools that's what we need to do next and fixing to making changes to the framework without addressing this support gap is is not going to improve anything and if anything it's going to set us back because we simply can't the office of school quality can't be can't have it has not been particularly successful to date frankly because it's already overextended and we're only going to overextend it more miss Ashton

[05:25:29] I'm not quite done, if I may finish. Sorry, just Robert's rule says further discussion. This is not a discussion, so are you asking questions? No, no, this is my argument in favor of why we should not vote in favor of this support framework, and I'm submitting my argument for consideration by fellow board members.

[05:25:53] Make it concise, because we're going on. I'm almost done. Discussion, Robert's rule says discussion, doesn't say discussion. Speeches well, I I think this is by way of discussion and I'm almost done But I'll await madam president's ruling and whether I may proceed. Are you calling the question?

[05:26:15] So that means I'm not allowed to finish by my argument to my board members as to why we why you should vote against this measure I believe that you have repeatedly told us throughout the discussion today This meeting and in many many meetings before what your position is I think that we are continuing to spend time on the same exact argument Like I said before we had the same discussion at the last board meeting. So yes Miss Holden, I respect you tremendously You have I want to also emphasize

[05:26:55] We disagree. I do not. And again, I think it's okay for us to disagree. And we as a board do need to move on. I don't think that there's any if there's anything new that you're offering. I haven't heard anything new in this last year, specifically related to this accountability framework. I think you've pushed us. You've asked for models, you've asked for different data points. I think that the team has tried to respond.

[05:27:23] and I'm ready to move forward so again respectfully this is not a discussion if you're asking us a question please ask us a question but we are ready I'm ready to move forward so president Creasy I'm asking you to call the question madam president I just want to note and I would like this note in the record with the term failing schools is continue to be used I've read all this I may have missed it but it's not in there anywhere it's not a term of art it's not a term we've used and I think you know I don't have a problem with a little more debate but I will cede to the will of the group but I do want to

[05:27:59] make sure for the record it is it will be it is a mischaracterization if it goes that we are passing something that's gonna label schools failures you can see the framework you can see the terminology which is deliberate because that failure rhetoric gets everybody spun up understandably but it's it's a red herring and it's not an accurate characterization of what we're doing it's just going to leave in terms of parents it's going to leave parents confused and we've seen some of that already and needlessly concerned about things they don't need to be concerned about and so I just want to make sure that is that is corrected in any of our communications Miss Holton if you can finish your

[05:28:33] comment in ten seconds well I can do 60 seconds I don't know if I can do ten well then I'll accept your ruling I can't do it okay mr. Hansen miss Kilgore

[05:28:46] Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Bryce? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Holton? No. Chair votes aye. Is there a motion to approve Virginia's ESSA state plan and grant the Virginia Department of Education with the ability to work with the U.S. Department of Education to provide technical updates to Virginia's ESSA state plan and should the U.S. Department of Education request any changes to Virginia's ESSA state plan that would be considered substantial policy changes.

[05:29:18] based on previous board decision, the Virginia Department of Education will bring forth the ESSA State Plan for board review. So moved. Second. Is there any discussion? Madam President, could you read that motion a second time?

[05:29:37] So the motion is to approve the ESSA State Plan and grant the Department of Education the ability to work with the U.S. Department of Education to provide any technical updates to the plan. And should the Department of Education, the U.S. Department of Education, request any changes to Virginia's plan, it would be considered substantial policy changes and have to come back to the board.

[05:30:01] We're still good on the motion and the second, so is there any discussion on this before we go? Mr. Hanson. Aye. Ms. Kilgore. Aye. Ms. Ashton. Aye. Dr. Bryce. Aye. Mr. Rotherham.

[05:30:17] Aye. Ms. McPherson. Aye. Ms. Holton. No. And chair votes aye. Okay, we are moving to item I. Chad and Ann, we thank you tremendously for all of your work, your collaboration, your continued night and day changing of things and adding to our needed data points all the time.

[05:30:56] So we appreciate your continued work, and we know we'll continue to see you, obviously. Thanks. Thank you, President Creasy, Vice President Hanson, members of the board, and Superintendent Coons.

[05:31:12] What we have for you today is a first review of regulatory actions resulting from periodic reviews that were approved at the July board meeting. So as you recall, we presented the results of a number of the periodic reviews of regulatory chapters and a number of those had suggestions for future regulatory work.

[05:31:31] And so we're bringing those items to you now for approval to start that work. I will be honest, this is a fairly modest list in terms of what we are looking to do. you might recall from the July board meeting, we had four chapters, the technology standards for instructional personnel, the regulations governing school community programs, the regulations governing school boards local, and regulations governing the reduction of state aid when the length of the school term is below 180 days that were recommended for repeal.

[05:32:02] And so essentially what we're doing is we are going through the process now in the regulatory regulatory process of repealing those chapters so that we can keep the board's current regulations up to date. All of those chapters were recommended for repeal. And then we have some modest revisions to three additional chapters, just again to update these regulations. Most of them have not been touched in a couple of decades. So for the regulations governing adult high school programs, We have a very modest recommendation to expand the board's offerings to allow for more external

[05:32:39] degree competency programs to count towards adult high school program graduation credits. Along with that, we will be asking that you issue an approval under the revised regs to count the current national external degree competencies program issued by CASAS to count is the board's first approval, just to make sure that the status quo is -- stays the same.

[05:33:04] We certainly don't want any change in the coverage, but we do want to make sure that the board is able to consider additional programs. In the process, we will remove a current document incorporated by reference, which is the CASAS external competencies, and in the process also, you know, engage in some regulatory reduction.

[05:33:24] We also have some modest, you know, revisions to the classification of expenditures in order to align with statutes and some modest revisions to the regulations governing school activity funds which are just updates removing some unnecessary language and again you know trying to make sure that these regulatory chapters stay stay up to date and current we will be bringing this back I anticipate at the September meeting for final review but would be happy to to try and address any questions if the board might have that are there questions okay thank you

[05:33:59] Mr. Chapman this will be heard again in September and I think you are also on board for item J that's correct thank you madam president what we're presenting to you again for first review our proposed technical revisions to the bylaws of the board the primary impetus for this revision of the bylaws is changes to state FOIA law and so in the process you might recall back in December of last year the board approved its first all virtual public meeting policies which is not applicable to the board itself, since it has the ability to revoke professional licenses, but it does apply to its required advisory committees.

[05:34:41] The board also has in its current bylaws some directions governing remote participation. Essentially the changes that went into effect in state law now require that those policies be adopted by a public body every single year.

[05:34:56] And so we think that the right strategies to remove these from the bylaws in order to be sure that this policy can then be adopted yearly by the board. It's a little bit easier for the board to adopt a policy than it is to revise the bylaws. Obviously, that's a fairly large operation, something that should be done very carefully.

[05:35:13] So by removing these components, the board will be able to be a little bit more nimble in keeping up with state law. We have included as attachment to exactly these policies. It's the all-virtual public meeting policies for the board's required advisory committees, as well as new directions governing remote participation that have been -- we've consulted with the Office of the Attorney General, just to make sure these are in accordance with state law.

[05:35:41] In the process of revising the bylaws for these, we've also gone through a series of minor edits, some clarifications, just to make sure that, again, this language is up to date. One of the strategies -- and you'll notice a lot of red text in here, a lot of strikethrough text is that things that the board is already obligated to do under either the Virginia Constitution or under state law, we have removed from the bylaws. Since the bylaws can't change those requirements in state law, and since they're already standing obligations, we don't think that they're appropriate for the bylaws. And so, you know, by removing them, we get to make this a much shorter document, which at least in some versions of legal logic makes it a more friendly

[05:36:18] document and so uh so that's essentially the revisions we have for you today um would this be the place for me to suggest some additional opportunities here i know that we've had some special meetings and i think particularly for opportunities like today's meeting i would like to at least have it for a discussion item for the next meeting whether or not we want to ensure that our special meetings are just that and so we would limit public comment to the

[05:36:54] items on the agenda rather than broad public comment any other comments or things that yes Mr. Rotherham well first of all I like to think that all of our meetings are special but I have a question about with our new room which is fantastic in our new space and it's terrific the public can access it so easily for public comment but how what are our plans for remote meetings in here and we don't necessarily I think we just need to pay a little attention to that as members travel or have

[05:37:33] personal uh things as we come into a season where more people are getting sick yeah I do think that that's being worked on obviously the team is continuing to innovate with each one of our meetings as we you know make this home for lack of a better term so I do think that we're going continue to see those innovations as time moves forward. So appreciate the comment. Thank you. Anything else on this? Madam President. Ms. Holton. Just a request, a suggestion when we see this again next month. If we take out the as proposed the

[05:38:10] language that's mandated by statute taking it out of the bylaws, can we put it in an appendix or a footnote or something to the bylaws so that we do have one document that contains all that information so that when we're referring to what our governing documents are we have it all in one place that's good anything else okay mr. Chapman will accept this item for first review and

[05:38:44] see you again in September on it thank you okay we are moving to presentation so this presentation is going to be on the standard setting process for standards of learning assessments do you guys need to get heated up on the anywhere do we need a quick break anybody I think it would be great yeah can we can we take about a six-minute break please get everybody set thank you

[05:39:17] learning assessments and what I would just like to remind us of is that we

[05:48:20] were tasked and and I think embody the desire to raise expectations for all students both raising the floor and raising the ceiling at the same time as we are find ourselves in a place where our fourth and eighth grade expectations in terms of our standards cut scores are reflectively the the lowest in the nation and we need to get us to a place where we are looking at that differently

[05:48:54] and so that is what today's discussion or not discussion but presentation is about and so I will let our esteemed presenter take over thank you madam president superintendent Coons members of the board happy to be with you this afternoon I know I'm the last person on a long day so I'll be succinct and save as much time as the board would please for questions and reflections but I just have a few comments to make I was asked to talk generally about the standard setting process from my role as a member of Virginia's Technical Advisory

[05:49:32] Committee. I'll start by just saying a bit about myself and my organization. So I work for a group called the National Center for the Improvement of Educational Assessment. We're a non-profit based in Dover, New Hampshire. We work with most of the states. We're currently working with more than 35 states. I think we've worked with more than 40 at some point. And we're at the intersection of policy, technical support, implementation. And so our mission is to really help build capacity with state departments of education and help them implement strong assessment and accountability solutions and again my role here today is specifically as a member of the Technical Advisory Committee it's a group that I've been

[05:50:09] with since 2018 and as you see on slide 7 I serve with a very distinguished group of assessment leaders you see their names they are Greg Syzak Suzanne Lane Barbara Plake anyway they all bring

complimentary expertise to bear on questions that the department brings to us related to the development of the assessment system related to implementing certain decisions and pressure testing and evaluating some of the work that the contractors do in some ways the TAC really serves as a partner to the department helping to look over the shoulder of the contractor to make sure that the work is strong and meets

[05:50:48] professionally accepted practices and we meet formally a couple times a year and then informally I interact with the department as needed. And you see here on slide eight some of the areas that we often are asked to provide advice on. Our advice is just that, advice.

[05:51:04] It goes as recommendations to the department. We often reflect on practices related to professional standards, related to what's happening across the country in our own areas of expertise. Today I'm going to be leaning into standard setting in particular. As the president teed up, what I want to talk about is the process is the process that's contemplated for setting performance standards for Virginia's SOL, and we'll talk broadly about that process, and I can certainly dwell on any details that the board would be interested in.

[05:51:37] So standard setting is the term that we use to describe a process used to determine the minimum performance that's required for each performance level. If you think about that as a cut score, since these are adaptive assessments, it's not as simple as a single raw score on the assessments what we're looking at is a performance threshold or you could just think of it in shorthand as what's good enough performance in order to meet performance levels of basic proficient advance and so forth sometimes people are surprised to learn that standard settings not an entirely empirical and technical exercise that it brings

[05:52:13] together expertise from subject matter experts and judges frequently that expertise is found in classroom educators curriculum specialists we are particularly interested in making sure it's informed by persons who have deep expertise in Virginia standards and also know Virginia students and can bring their knowledge and perspectives and expertise to bear in that process and one of the points I'd want to foreground now and throughout the presentation is the credibility of the resulting outcome of the cut scores is

[05:52:48] really about the process so what the TAC would advise the department is to ensure that the process is strong it's research-based it's implemented with fidelity and by attending to those aspects we believe the standards will have more credibility certainly there's it's a policy decision ultimately and that's why it rests with this board but I think the board would want to know when they are asked to make a recommendation of that policy decision that it comes to them having gone through a very credible, structured process in which you can have confidence.

[05:53:22] And that's really what you mentioned here on slide 10. We want to be very transparent, making sure the board knows their role in approving those cut scores, and making sure the board is very clear on how that's happening, and if we can answer any questions to inform that, that's hopefully what I can contribute to today.

[05:53:39] I know the president started by mentioning rigor as being a particularly important policy priority that's informing this initiative and i would want to say that the rigor is influenced by multiple factors i would i would propose that standard setting is the process itself is necessary but not sufficient in order to establish the desired level of rigor that virginia policymakers have rigor is informed by the

content standards themselves and i know this board has invested their attention in the content standards and the standards of learning certainly the characteristics of the assessment matter so we rely on having a good assessment that reflects

[05:54:17] those content standards well includes the kinds of items that elicit the targeted learning outcomes so for example we want to measure higher order thinking skills or deeper levels of cognitive complexity that we have the content that can elicit those demonstrations standard setting can't can't fix a lack of that and I know that the department has prioritized that and that is in fact a characteristic of Virginia's assessments and of course that those items are brought together in form specifications blueprints that reflect the measurable skills and content standards that are prioritized for Virginia students and then the third component are policy decisions and

[05:54:57] obviously this board serves as a provide policy direction and often if you go to slide 12 you'll see that those get instantiated in documents such as policy level descriptors and every state has policy level descriptors to some degree of detail and it's really a it's an overall statement it's neutral of grading content areas that reflects the vision for where what ought to distinguish those gradations of below basic to basic to proficient and advanced and if you look at those policy descriptors these are these would look familiar if you lay

[05:55:36] these alongside those from some other states. They speak to aspects such as the extent to which a student demonstrates extensive knowledge, does so consistently, does so with respect to content that's more or less rigorous.

[05:55:52] Those get reflected in these policy level descriptors, the key word there being policy. And then from these, the contractor will develop performance level descriptors, which are much more elaborated statements about knowledge, skills, and abilities that students need to demonstrate in order to satisfy the criteria associated with basic, proficient, and advanced performance.

[05:56:15] And actually there's a lot of flavors of policy level descriptors. I'll keep it high level for now. There's range descriptors, there's threshold descriptors, but I think the message I would want to carry to the board right now is from these policy descriptors, the contractor will create specific lists of skills and demonstrations that help fulfill the activities of standard setting, which I'll detail here just now.

[05:56:42] So moving to slide 13, standard setting, we like to think of it as operationalizes those performance level descriptors, and again, gives rise to cut scores or those good enough thresholds for each of those performance levels across all the grade and content areas that are assessed.

[05:57:01] There are different methods for standard setting. Journals are just full of different articles these methods and about variations in these methods there are item centered approaches such as Angoff which I believe the previous standard setting method was influenced primarily by modifications to an Angoff methodology there's a bookmark method the method we're going to talk about today is the ID matching method which really brings in elements that I think represent strong aspects of both Angoff and bookmark there are examinee approaches such as borderline groups contrasting groups we find that item centered approaches are more common and more appropriate for criterion referenced assessments such as

[05:57:40] the Virginia SOLs and I would want to be candid with the board and say there's not a consensus best method you'll find some variation if you speak to folks that work in this field about which standard

setting method is most appropriate but I think the field is of one voice about the characteristics that accompany strong implementations of these methods you see some of those here on slide 13 these methods all rely on well-qualified experts that they have procedures that they know very clearly that they follow with fidelity that the process is designed to center those experts judgments on the performance

[05:58:19] level descriptors and strong procedures often also have elements to promote coherence the technical term for that is vertical articulation what we want to make sure is that the standards are sensible across grades so again just in the shorthand if the standards look like a roller coaster across you know the rigor is really high for grade four really low for grade five and high for the next grade then one could argue that's contrary to coherence what that pattern looks like is a matter of some judgments a matter of what level of rigor is reflected in the content standards but there should be some

[05:58:56] attention to that pattern across grades in addition to attention to the decisions made within grade and content area. So a little bit more about the ID matching procedure. You'll see on slide 14 the the general procedures. As I mentioned, the judges will review the performance level descriptors in some detail. They actually spend a non-turbulent amount of time in the activity really investing in those qualitative statements about the knowledge skills that students should demonstrate at each level to ensure there's a really clear and comprehensive understanding because those are so

[05:59:35] central to the process it's also important that the participants in standard setting understand the test very deeply as well so there's a substantial amount of time devoted in the process to reviewing the test and making sure educators understand how that test reflects and brings content together to elicit the demonstrations called for in the PLDs. And then in multiple rounds, I believe the plan and it varies a little bit from state to state, two or three rounds. I believe the plan in Virginia is to do this in three rounds. Participants will review an ordered item booklet, items that are

[06:00:13] ordered from easiest to most difficult. It's representing a range of content be reflective of a student's test experience and the the central aspect of ID matching is they will take each item that's presented in that OIB and make a determination about which performance level it matches best to so you can imagine you see this figure at the bottom of slide 14 what that might look like if you're doing this starting with the easiest items to the most rigorous items that there'll be some items that almost everybody will agree on probably

[06:00:51] with these addressing knowledge and skills that are associated with below basic or blaze basic as they get more difficult then the judges will say oh this is more focused on the skills that are described in this proficient policy level descriptor excuse me performance level descriptors on up to those that are advanced of course it's there's never a full agreement right away they'll always be a little bit of variation and where that variation occurs will be a little cloudiness in terms of how each person's decision is playing out we call those threshold regions and in subsequent rounds they'll take a closer

[06:01:30] look at those threshold reasons regions we'll say oh it from from this item to this item is where we start to diverge in terms of your judgments and so let's take a closer look at the skills that are called upon in these items and reference them with the performance level descriptors and by so doing the panel begins to coalesce on a shared view of where that performance threshold should reside there's and the reason you do it in multiple rounds is they learn along the way they learn from their colleagues perspectives and contributions in those conversations they get to inspect their own reasoning and in

[06:02:06] strong processes we find that that variation begins to reduce from round to round you might have a lot of disagreement in the first round and it's very satisfying if by the third round we start to see a lot more agreement on where those judges are and that's an indication that the process is working as intended and that it's producing something that represents a shared position of a qualified expert judge and there's some statistical ways that the that you take that threshold region and determine how that cut score gets translated as a performance threshold I can talk about that in more details of

[06:02:44] interest to the board but the concept is that that central value in the threshold region gets translated as a cut score and then as I mentioned the final part of the process is to examine results across grades so everything that I talked about here before is happening within a grade and content area panel then we'll look at it across all panels and make any adjustments as needed to ensure that it's appropriately coherent and then finally standard settings should be well documented from start to finish and that documentation available for inspection it would be part of tax protocol to look at a standard setting

[06:03:21] plan in advance of the event and to look at the report following the event and that's something we will work with the department to provide good partnership on going to slide 15 I think I mentioned a few of the advantages of the ID matching procedure and I'll conclude my remarks here it's a very well-established procedure so certainly it's not something that Virginia would be cutting its teeth on it's been used by numerous large-scale state programs it's been around since the early 90s and my read it's grown considerably in the past a decade and again I think it's the feature that people really seem to like

[06:03:56] about ID matching is what we call the cognitive task and methods like Angoff that asks for participants to make predictions about the percent of students that might be successful in an item whereas this one is simply looking at the item characteristics and the performance level descriptors and matching those based on their judgments about what kind of performance satisfies each performance level so but again ID matching takes into account some of the strong aspects of other methods like having the expert panels having the multiple rounds of review having the vertical articulation so I think it's a

[06:04:35] very strong method it's very well established across the country and as I note here in the third bullet it can be adapted to incorporate the priorities of the board of the State Department regarding the kind of information you might want to share with the panel how you want to train the panel so there is there are some degrees of freedom to how you can implement it to make sure it reflects the priorities of the State Department of Education so that concludes my prepared remarks I'd be happy to entertain any questions where they have anyone have questions mr. Rotherham you good yeah thank you this is fantastic I

[06:05:14] have a couple of questions um one on the on the method which you know you talk about well-qualified experts could you say a little more about that because something I've wondered about is we've had a disconnect often between what's considered success at the high school level and then college professors will say no you know if you're coming into me at Virginia Tech or William & Mary George Mace whatever you're not you're not gonna succeed in my class at that level so when you say well qualified experts obviously teachers curriculum experts but like what's the role to make sure you do get good articulation up and down so it's actually predictive of at the next level and you can obviously then

[06:05:52] take that down so things we're doing for middle school high school teachers are engaged and say you're gonna be successful in my class or not and then again at the elementary level it's an excellent question it's one of those areas that I think fall into that category that it's a flexibility that can be adapted to

reflect the policy priorities of the department a commonly again what we're looking for are experienced educators and experts with respect to the standards of learning and we also look for you know we want to be broadly representative of the state so we want to make sure people aren't concentrated in one region we wanted to be broadly representative of the kinds of students that are served so for example we would want expertise we would want

[06:06:31] some panelists that have worked with multi-language learners we would want some panelists that work with special populations we want to make sure that people look at that panel and say this is a nice cross-section of the expertise we have in the state of Virginia but I've seen states that will occasionally bring people in roles other than teachers or say district curriculum directors I've seen states bring in representatives from institutions of higher education for example that might be particularly relevant for a high school assessment because they can speak to the kinds of skills and demonstrations that are important for success in a post-secondary environment

[06:07:08] so again it's with any decision it's really important to ensure that every judge can contribute expertise to Virginia standards but they might be drawing on personal experiences and areas of expertise to enhance their contributions okay so madam president that's thing I'd like us to just to think about to make sure that we're that we have you know what we talk about that these that these things are actually predictive and meaningful because I think we sometimes people have been caught off guard we say you're passing and then people assume let's you know that's like a college ready standard and then it's it's not and so and then my second so that's saying pay attention then

[06:07:44] my second question transparency and you talked about how everything is documented like what's best practice this was years ago so I'm sure it's completely outdated but I did a study on cut score transparency at the state level, and very, very few states actually made it, in some states it was just impossible to find, some states it was difficult, very few states like made it just easy for the public to see.

[06:08:07] And per the conversations we've been having, I don't know if you were here before, we've been having today around changes we're making, it's going to be very important to the public actually understand like what it is and not have to dig, be a power user and dig deep through our website. So, like, what are best practices on helping people understand cut scores, which can also be confusing because if it's a really demanding assessment, the cut score may be actually quite low, and we don't want people to be like, oh, that's easy.

[06:08:32] So it's complicated. So what lessons or advice should we be considering in terms of just communicating clearly what's going on? Great question. I think I would start with detailed documentation about the process. I think this we should have a process in which the state can be proud that follows established professional practices and there's no reason to obscure that information and but really then it's about Good guidance about score interpretation and use so I don't know if implied in your question is like what the role of raw scores is

[06:09:06] Raw scores will be problematized in this context both because in a fixed form raw scores can change from administration to administration because tests vary and they'll be equated to have levels of difficulty that could change but even more so in Virginia because they're adaptive assessments and so the raw score of the number correct that represents the good enough threshold will be different for every student depending on the form that's customized to their experience so the strongest advice I would give is

to make sure there's good scoring interpretation guides we're seeing states that are going beyond these written documentation and doing webinars

[06:09:44] and trainings and other initiatives to help the field really understand how to interpret and use scores in appropriate ways and and the last thing I'd say is to make sure that the field understands the limits of longitudinal comparability after those new standards are set so when those new standards are set making claims about changes in performance to prior tests will be distorted because we have new standards thank you Dr. Domolesky this is really

[06:10:24] helpful I've heard from our staff many times over the years how this process works and I'm still always befuddled by it and I know a number of our board members will be going through it for the first time since we've adopted new standards for both math and literacy and we'll be setting cut scores this year for those so this is great timing for us to try to understand this process better and it's really helpful to have the benefit of you and the other experts on the TAC on the TAC helping us understand and helping that I know the

[06:10:59] department's grateful for your help one of my questions and we we heard this from I think the Association of State Superintendents earlier how I'm hearing that there is a proposal is to do things somewhat differently this time than we have in the past in Virginia and just trying to understand what's different so I hear one difference is changing from essentially modified and golf to this ID setting can you tell me what the implications of that change are and can

[06:11:37] you tell me whether there are other proposed changes so forgive my company no no that's an excellent question thank you yeah I'd say I wouldn't want to overstate the difference in the method the method is a tool and the tool in the hands of skilled practitioners is what's going to ultimately accomplish what we hope to accomplish here and I would describe standard setting having an established standard setting process as a necessary but insufficient tool in order to to get these cut scores where they should be the the other elements as

[06:12:16] I mentioned are related to the content standards related to the performance level descriptors related to the characteristics on the assessment they all really work together to to define where those thresholds are going to be for the new performance expectations so but but i wouldn't want to overstate that the method itself is overly influential the method works in combination with those other factors to create the appropriate performance standards madam president miss olton uh so uh in term in the in the what's different or what's proposed to be different are the uh performance level descriptors

[06:12:54] the uh policy level descriptors are those on slide 12 are those new or are those the same as is what we've always had I I don't know about the performance of the policy level descriptors the performance level descriptors must be new because they're they're being used to inform new standards so you can see the policy level descriptor is a very high level so I'm not understanding the distinction between those two certainly yes policy level descriptors are what you see on slide 12 right that's again that's we don't those cut across all grades and content areas of broad statements about the the general characteristics of each performance

[06:13:34] level. Superintendent Koons may know if these are new or if these are similar to ones that have been used in the past but regardless of the performance level descriptors those more detailed statements of the knowledge and skills those will be new and they should be new every time there's a standard setting.

[06:13:52] That's really what standard settings all about is foregrounding those those statements and using them to recover the thresholds and that up madam president may I miss Holton so the performance level descriptors that's more detailed that's not in these slides but that is part of the what you described as the detailed information about the process that should be public at some point in the appropriate shared in the appropriate manner with the public yes ma'am it is common for states to make performance level

[06:14:25] descriptors publicly available. And then in terms of the process, as I understand it, what our traditional path has been is we have what we've always called standard setting committees, which are comprised primarily, but not exclusively necessarily, of teachers and curriculum specialists for each test, each grade level, reviewing each item and assessing it. Correct. According to these criteria and then an articulation committee that's comprised primarily of

[06:15:05] those same educators exactly and others reviewing for coherence across grades exactly so what's what's commonly done our representatives from each of those grade content panels will come together for the articulation panel so you might pick two or three people from each of the grade content panels to come together for the articulation panel and then madam president may I treat this as work session for just yes thanks that that the recommendations of the standard setting committee and then the articulation committee and then usually a set of recommendations from the superintendent would all be presented to

[06:15:44] us so we've seen a report that included included all three of those levels standard setting committee articulation committee superintendent and then it's presented to us for actual decisions as a technical advisor I wouldn't be able would speak deeply about the process for the board what information the board will get when and how to be presented but I can tell you that what you've described is very characteristic of what I'm familiar with in other states and and as far in maybe dr. Coons can help on this but there's no proposal to change that in Virginia that you know of but you might not know it's what I'm hearing you say um if I'm understanding your your your question correctly there's no

[06:16:22] intent to do something that's outside of established professional practices everything that I've reviewed looks solidly consistent with what I would expect to see in a strong process that is consistent with professional standards and and so then our role is essentially at the end of this process do we have another are there other places where we should have a role I see the the notion of adapted to incorporate priorities of the program item is there is there a role that a board should be playing other than at the end of the process that's

[06:17:01] probably not the question that I should answer yeah I would leave it to the madam president superintendent Coons to provide reflections on how you'd like the board to be involved dr. Coons I think member Holton the intent today was to provide a preliminary conversation you are asking way down the road questions so we are happy to come back and provide updates to the questions that you're asking today but the team is not prepared to have this conversation this time okay thank you and and if I may just follow up then what's what what is our proposed role and what is proposed to change from past practice and

[06:17:38] can we hear that in time that if we so that we can have input on proposed changes to the practice so if we're going to be making cut score decisions are going to be presented to us I think the timeline says in January February hopefully that would be September or October that we would have a more detailed fleshing out of the proposed process is that fair so the purpose of today's presentation was

literally to get us get our feet wet on this topic right so that what that means is we will be progress progressing down the road into what our role is as the board and what the department's role is in the

[06:18:17] coming months yes so September or October would be a realistic time frame Yeah, to come back to us. Yes. Thank you. And then if I may I see slides at the beginning of this process about the nape and the so-called honesty gap What role if any does that play in what our current standard-setting process is or What role might that play in proposed new standard-setting process?

[06:18:49] So the slides at the beginning, I believe President Creasy may want to speak to those. Those are slides that I did not prepare, but the way I interpret them is that they're a very crisp statement of the policy priorities that have inspired thinking about the standard setting.

[06:19:07] If I may, just as a follow-up, how would the NAEP, describing the process that we have used in the past, do the NAEP scores play a role at all? And if so, is there a way, if not, is there a way to appropriately use them?

[06:19:25] I can reflect based on my experience working with other states that it is, I would say that's configurable. It is, some states will use external reference as part of the process. They might take ACT, ACT scores, NAEP scores, historical information, and add that to the information that's provided to the standard setting panelists.

[06:19:48] other states um don't prioritize that information so i would i would describe that as a configurable aspect of the standard setting process and as i understand the pro the plan is still being developed all those details so decisions like that are probably forthcoming but just to give you an example of how one might attend to the data that that you asked about mr rotherham so i would do one more question on this to bring us back to the technical side can you talk with us about we have an adaptive assessment can you talk about any unique uh any unique issues we should be

[06:20:24] thinking about with regard to setting cut scores with adaptive assessments and like any challenges with setting it for grades above below just i think you know for a lot of us that's that that's a newer process it's a great question and the good news is is this um certainly it's ground that's been covered in our field in the past adaptive assessments are increasingly common so we have fairly established procedures for how to do that. What it means is that there won't be a single intact form that we can bring to standard settings. So if there was just one fixed form that all students in Virginia took, we could take that form or a parallel form to standard setting and we could say this is the

[06:21:02] test that all students took or that some students took. With adaptive testing, the contractor needs to create a form that's broadly representative of the range of skills and content that students will encounter from the full range of expertise there but once you have that the way the measurement model works item response theory we can once we identify where those threshold regions are we can translate that to any student's assessment experience so it's it's honestly really behind the scenes for the standard setters they wouldn't notice a difference from a fixed form to an adaptive state without being privy

[06:21:37] to this kind of conversation madam president miss Walton I have two more areas of question one is will the traditionally in Virginia we have had a transition year when we've rolled over to a new set of standards and this year we are not doing that so my question is are there recommended from your expert position are there things we should do to accommodate or help address the fact

[06:22:14] that the tests that these committee members are going to be evaluating is a test they haven't yet utilized with students and there's other ways we can compensate for the lack of a transition year so transition with respect to performance standards I would distinguish from transition respect to the rollout of new academic standards altogether and I think the the latter is where you often see more focus whenever there are new academic standards it's obviously important to make sure that there's resources deployed to make sure that educators understand those standards and have opportunities to to implement

[06:22:53] those but once the once those standards are assessed and new performance thresholds are set in my experience it's not common to delay implementation of those performance thresholds possible there's a state that's phased them in I can't immediately recall if that's the case but I would really focus my reflections on the efforts that occur after adoption of new academic standards as opposed to the assessment side of the whole equation but that is where we are in Virginia we've adopted new academic standards on both math and literacy that were and that our teachers are now teaching from for the first year and some

[06:23:31] of the supportive material has been rolled out some has not so for instance there's no math textbooks can I just jump in here I'm not sure that that is the issue that's not directly related to this particular presentation it might might be from a larger perspective but that's not that's not the intent of this presentation so I think this is a policy discussion that's worthy of the board having I think it's sort of outside of the purview of this particular presentation. Madam President I would submit that it's important work and it's

[06:24:08] I also work that Dr. Domoleski, it's absolutely within his expertise, I think. And if not, I'm absolutely confident he's a professional and can tell us that. I would love to have his advice while we've got him here, and maybe we'll continue to have him here for later meetings. But while we've got him here, I would love to have his advice on what, if anything, we can do to adjust to that circumstance where our standard setting committees will be working with a test that they haven't had a transition year on. Dr. Coons? Yeah I think I want I would ask that the questions that are the purview of the department or the board we have

[06:24:48] very graciously had one of our TAC advisors come to give us an overview on the standard setting process but some of the questions you're asking are under the purview of the board and the department and I would prefer that those be held to the September October meeting if you're going to ask questions about particular processes or rollout of materials or things that are in the purview of the department or the board my hope would be that the department is going to get the benefit of his expertise and the tax expertise on questions like the we regularly do that yes right so can I ask my question can I

[06:25:23] ask can he answer my question or not I do I do think that it's micromanaging the department's role in this process if this line of questioning is so you're saying I cannot ask the question but okay I've asked the question and if he can answer it great and if he can't then I'm sure he can tell us that I think it's fair to say that this is getting into areas that I'm less familiar with and I would just be concerned that I don't have the depth of familiarity with the policy and the procedures of Virginia to give you insight that's It's going to be as helpful as you might otherwise like.

[06:26:00] Then I can ask one different question. Go ahead. Do you anticipate that you and the other members of the TAC are going to be engaged with the department on the proposed changes to the process that are going to be shared with us over the upcoming months?

[06:26:21] I expect that the TAC will work closely with the department on establishing the standard setting procedures, monitoring its implementation, and reviewing the outcomes. Great. Thank you. Dr. Tomoleski, I just want to thank you.

[06:26:39] You have been a tremendous member of the TAC for our team and for us and for coming out and launching this process. So really appreciate the work and your expertise and your national expertise in helping the department as we're thinking about setting standards and standards setting with an adaptive test and the challenges that that has.

[06:26:59] So we really appreciate your expertise. Thank you so much. Thank you very much. Thank you. Thank you. okay our final item is current issues i think dr coons has something that she needs is there anybody that has a discussion of current issues no okay dr coons it's all you i just want to provide the board with several updates around topics that we've talked about in the past as

[06:27:34] we talked about last month the executive order on cell phone free education the draft policy guidelines and guidelines for school divisions to boards to take a look at is on the website through September 16th we have heard repeatedly through comment our teacher advisory council yesterday have talked about the positive impact of having cell phone free education in particular bell-to-bell cell phone free opportunities that is having on their classrooms I was in Fredericksburg on Sunday and I think Fredericksburg Spotsylvania King George several

[06:28:10] communities talked about the positive impacts as well as our teachers last night on their call so really appreciate the opportunity for everyone to give us feedback over the next couple weeks and move forward and making sure our students have the opportunity to be focused on education and remove the barriers and impacts of cell phones during school the assessment RFI was posted Monday morning that will run through the entire month of September that RFI proposes several things from the 585 report and some of the standards and changes that we've discussed here as well as the performance tasks that are

[06:28:48] part of the performance and support framework I wanted to give just a clarifying statement around the CNBC's methodology for saying we are the number one state for education in America this ranking was heavily focused on Virginia's robust college and university system and the state support for higher education as well as our historically black colleges and universities and comprehensive community college and career education systems the focus on education had multiple measures especially emphasizing class sizes and spending this year was a record year for funding in k-12 schools with an

[06:29:26] increase of more than 2 billion dollars over the biennium that played a large part in that number one rating the component of test scores is a very small spark it's part of that rating and reflecting the spirit of of what we've done there was a 21.3 biennial investment in education 196 million dollars in additional funding for at-risk students 25 million dollars of additional funding for English language learners and 15 million dollars of additional funding and supplemental grant programming and 243 million in additional payments to local school divisions by reinstating tax hold

[06:30:06] harmless payment over the biennium I do want to state that we had a major announcement on student performance last Tuesday we are one of the first states to announce our statewide chronic absenteeism rate we have had a 16% reduction from 22 23 which was 19.3% we are currently sitting at 16.1% that is our federal rating for chronic absenteeism but that represents 40,974

[06:30:37] students who attend school regularly overall we had 1.276 million fewer absent days which resulted in nine million dollars nine million dollars nine million additional hours of instruction that is a huge testament to the hard work that all of our school divisions are doing and the emphasis that they are playing and using their community resources to ensure students attend school every day according to our data this year those students who continue to struggle with attendance scored 19 percentage points below their peers in reading

[06:31:14] and 26 percentage points below their peers in math overall 80 over 80 percent of our school divisions increased their chronic absenteeism rankings and improved their attendance 70% of our school division showed improvements in reading sol scores 75% of our school division showed improvement in math sol scores More importantly if we look at our students who are most hit by the pandemic our economically disadvantaged students Doubled the rate of all students in the post pandemic reading growth Our English learners rate grew more than six times the rate in the post pandemic growth

[06:31:51] I do want to mention we've spent a lot of time talking about our English learners While they have grown at six times the rate, they are still one in three Students of our English learners are not proficient in math or reading not proficient We have to continue to take early intervention steps and make sure that we are Looking at our students closely and providing those supports our students with disabilities did grow at 1.2 times the rate of all students Which is a moment to celebrate but they are still significantly behind their peers So as we look at the first year of all-in we are seeing some small improvements overall

[06:32:30] But we have two additional years of all-in funding and we have a focus on the Virginia Literacy Act Which is implemented this year. So we have to continue to work hard We've had a progress check last week But we know our educators are up for the challenge and they are working hard But we are working to make sure that those growths continue. I do want to shout out the hundred and nineteen school divisions who are opting into free resources in math with Zerm and literacy with Ignite and Lexia.

[06:32:59] We want to appreciate everything that everyone is doing and know that we have to stay the course over the next several years. Thank you so much. Thank you. Ms. Ashton. Madam President, I would like to thank Dr. Coons and the staff.

[06:33:18] Thank you for those bright spot recognition. It's a great way to start this year. Dr. Coons I want to just thank you for always starting our day with our students it really sets the tone for the hard work that we are doing and there's nothing else on the agenda so I'd like to make a motion to adjourn okay first though I do have to do one thing I'm so sorry because we introduced Ida McPherson at our last board meeting we we gave your bio and all of your information at

[06:33:52] our last board meeting but you weren't your smiling face wasn't with us to be a part of that celebration so we would just like to welcome Ida McPherson to our board and our we are excited that you are with us we are happy to have a full and complete team here with us as we move forward I know Dr. Northern's not here today but we are excited for the future and thank you so much for commitment to the commonwealth and to this board and the students and families of the commonwealth

[06:34:29] so thank you and unless you would like to say anything would you like to say anything obviously the commonwealth in my opinion is asking that the board have a critical eye as it relates to education and moving forward i'd like to think maybe i could contribute to that i actually come from a background where when students were attending school we were completely segregated

[06:35:02] we moved a long way since then we had a lot less resources available but i can say that me and my friends and plenty of other students have succeeded i truly believe that we can still do that we've got a system that needs improvement we need to face that we need to be honest with the citizens of the commonwealth and if we all join in together i know we can make a difference and i'm here for that i'm going to be a champion for students parents teachers but i'm also going to bring a critical eye to how we're dealing with the problem thank you we're looking forward to your

[06:35:39] service with us thank you so miss ashton i'll let you i made a motion to adjourn and so we are adjourned